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Methods and apparatus for powering a vehicle

Abstract

A system for managing a vehicle's energy can comprise an energy generation system, one or more energy storage devices, and a hardware controller. The energy generation system can generate energy to provide to the one or more energy storages devices and/or to a motor of the vehicle. The hardware controller can selectively electrically couple the one or more energy storage devices to the energy generation system based on one or more conditions. The hardware controller can control an electrical coupling between the one or more energy storage devices based on charge levels or an energy demand of the motor.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/084,531, filed Oct. 29, 2020, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/847,538, filed Apr. 13, 2020, which claims benefit of priority and is related to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/858,902, filed Jun. 7, 2019, U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/883,523, filed Aug. 6, 2019, and U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/967,406, filed Jan. 29, 2020. The disclosures of each of these applications are incorporated herein in their entireties for all purposes. Any and all applications for which a foreign or domestic priority claim is identified in the Application Data Sheet as filed with the present application are hereby incorporated by reference under 37 CFR 1.57.

BACKGROUND

Field of the Disclosure

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to providing energy for a vehicle powered, at least in part, by electricity, and more specifically, to generating and conveying or storing the electricity for consumption by electric motors to drive or power the vehicle or a portion thereof while the vehicle is mobile.

Description of the Related Art

(2) Electric vehicles derive locomotion power from electricity often received from an energy storage device within the electric vehicle. The energy storage device could be a battery, a battery array, or an energy storage and/or containment device. Hybrid electric vehicles include regenerative charging that capture power from vehicle braking and traditional motors to charge the energy storage device and provide power to the vehicle. Battery electric vehicles (BEVs) are often proposed to have an energy storage/containment device (for example, a battery or battery array or capacitor array) that is charged through some type of wired or wireless connection at one or more stationary locations, for example household or commercial supply sources. The wired charging connections require cables or other similar connectors physically connected to a stationary power supply. The wireless charging connections require antenna(s) or other similar structures wirelessly connected to a power supply that generates a wireless field via its own antenna(s). However, such wired and wireless stationary charging systems may be inconvenient or cumbersome and have other drawbacks, such as degradation during energy transference, inefficiencies or losses, requiring a specific location for charging, and so forth. As such, alternatives for stationary wired or wireless charging systems and methods that efficiently and safely transfer power for charging electric vehicles are desirable.

SUMMARY

(3) Various embodiments of systems, methods and devices within the scope of the appended claims each have several aspects, no single one of which is solely responsible for the desirable attributes

described herein. Without limiting the scope of the appended claims, the description below describes some prominent features.

(4) Details of one or more embodiments of the subject matter described in this specification are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features, aspects, and advantages will become apparent from the description, the drawings, and the claims. Note that relative dimensions of the following figures may not be drawn to scale.

(5) In one aspect, an apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The apparatus includes a driven mass, a generator, a charger, a hardware controller, and a communication circuit. The driven mass is configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, wherein the driven mass exists in (1) an extended position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle causes the driven mass to rotate and (2) a retracted position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle does not cause the driven mass to rotate. The generator is configured to generate an electrical output based on a mechanical input, the generator having a pulley mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the pulley to rotate. The charger is electrically coupled to the generator and configured to receive the electrical output from the generator, generate a charge output based on the electrical output, and convey the charge output to the vehicle. The hardware controller is configured to control whether the driven mass is in the extended position or the retracted position in response to a signal received from a vehicle controller. The communication circuit is configured to receive the signal from the vehicle controller.

(6) In some aspects, the driven mass includes a wheel, and the extended position includes the wheel positioned in contact with a ground surface on which the vehicle travels. In some aspects, the charger includes a charging cable coupled to a charging port of the vehicle, and the charge output is conveyed to the vehicle via the charging cable and the charging port. In some aspects, apparatus further includes a circuit element positioned in series with the generator and the charger, wherein the circuit element creates an open circuit between the generator and the charging port of the vehicle. In some aspects, the apparatus further includes a filtering circuit configured to filter the electrical output from the generator before the electrical output from the generator is received by the charger, wherein filtering the electrical output includes one or more of filtering, cleaning, matching, converting, and conditioning the electrical output to reduce risk of damage to the charger by the electrical output. In some aspects, the driven mass includes a gear, and the extended position includes the gear engaged with one or more of a drive shaft, a motor, and a wheel of the vehicle. In some aspects, the pulley is mechanically coupled to the shaft by one or more of a chain, a belt, a gearing system, and a pulley system. In some aspects, the apparatus further comprises an energy storage device configured to store any excess portion of the charge conveyed to the vehicle when a vehicle battery or a vehicle motor is unable to accept all portions of the charge output conveyed from the charger. In some aspects, the energy storage device is further configured to convey the excess portion of the charge to the vehicle energy storage device or to the vehicle motor on demand. In some aspects, the apparatus further comprises a battery storage device and a capacitor storage device, wherein the capacitor storage device is configured to: receive at least a portion of the charge output, store at least the portion of the charge output, and convey at least the portion of the charge output to the battery storage device in one or more bursts based on a charge level of the battery storage device dropping below a threshold value.

(7) In some aspects, the mechanical input further comprises a flywheel configured to drive the generator to generate the electrical output. In some aspects, the apparatus further comprises a one-way bearing having a first side and a second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the first side rotate independently of the second side. In some aspects, the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, the shaft is coupled to the second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft. In some aspects, the apparatus further comprises an independent suspension that supports the

driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber. In some aspects, the generator is switchable such that the electrical output is pulsed in a first switched setting and is constant in a second switched setting. In some aspects,

(8) In another aspect, a method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The method includes rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, wherein the driven mass exists in (1) an extended position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle causes the driven mass to rotate and (2) a retracted position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle does not cause the driven mass to rotate. The method also may include generating an electrical output based on a mechanical input via a generator, the generator having a pulley mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the pulley to rotate. The method further may include, for example, generating a charge output based on the electrical output and conveying the charge output to the vehicle. The method also may further include controlling whether the driven mass is in the extended position or the retracted position in response to a signal received from a vehicle controller and receiving the signal from the vehicle controller.

(9) In some aspects, the driven mass comprises a wheel, and wherein the extended position comprises the wheel positioned in contact with a ground surface on which the vehicle travels. In some aspects, conveying the charge output to the vehicle comprises conveying the charge output via a charging cable coupled to a charging port of the vehicle. In some aspects, the method further comprises creating an open circuit between the generator and the charging port of the vehicle via a circuit element or filtering the electrical output from the generator before the electrical output from the generator is received by the charger, wherein filtering the electrical output includes one or more of filtering, cleaning, matching, converting, and conditioning the electrical output to reduce risk of damage to the charger by the electrical output. In some aspects, the driven mass comprises a gear, and wherein the extended position comprises the gear engaged with one or more of a drive shaft, a motor, and a wheel of the vehicle. In some aspects, the mechanical input is mechanically coupled to the shaft by one or more of a chain, a belt, a gearing system, and a pulley system. In some aspects, the method further comprises storing any excess portion of the charge conveyed to the vehicle when a vehicle battery or a vehicle motor is unable to accept all portions of the charge output conveyed from the charger or conveying the excess portion of the charge from the energy storage device to the vehicle energy storage device or to the vehicle on demand. In some aspects, the method further comprises receiving at least a portion of the charge output at a capacitor storage device, storing at least the portion of the charge output in the capacitor storage device, and/or conveying at least the portion of the charge output to a battery storage device in one or more bursts based on a charge level of the battery storage device dropping below a threshold value.

(10) In some aspects, the mechanical input comprises a flywheel configured to drive the generator to generate the electrical output. In some aspects, the mechanical input further comprises a one-way bearing having a first side and a second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the first side rotate independently of the second side in a first direction of rotation and with the second side in a second direction of rotation. In some aspects, the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, the shaft is coupled to the second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft in the first direction of rotation and with the shaft in the second direction of rotation. In some aspects, the method further comprises supporting, via an independent suspension, the driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber. In some aspects, the method further comprises switching the generator between generating a pulsed electrical output or a constant electrical output or performing a voltage dump from the generator output terminal via a capacitor, a switch assembly, and a backup energy storage.

(11) In another aspect, an apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The apparatus comprises a driven mass configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate and a generator configured to generate an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate. The apparatus further comprises a capacitor module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal and configured to: receive a first portion of the electrical output generated by the generator, store the first portion of the electrical output as a first energy as an electric field of the capacitor module, and convey the first energy to a load of the vehicle on demand. The apparatus further comprises a battery module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal and configured to: receive a second portion of the electrical output generated by the generator, store the second portion of the electrical output as a second energy in a chemical energy form, and convey the second energy to the load of the vehicle on demand. The hardware controller is configured to control whether the capacitor module, the battery module, or a combination of the capacitor module and the battery module is coupled to the generator output terminal in response to a received signal.

(12) In some aspects, the mechanical input comprises a flywheel configured to store mechanical energy received from the driven mass and the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, wherein the shaft is coupled to the second side, and wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft in the first direction of rotation and together with the shaft in the second direction of rotation. In some aspects, the apparatus further comprises an independent suspension that supports the driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber.

(13) In another aspect, a method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The method comprises rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, generating, via generator, an electrical output at a generator output terminal of the generator based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate, conveying a first portion of the electrical output generated by the generator to a capacitor module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal, storing the first portion of the electrical output as a first energy in an electric field of the capacitor module, conveying the first energy to a load of the vehicle on demand, conveying a second portion of the electrical output to a battery module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal, storing the second portion of the electrical output as a second energy in a chemical energy form, and controlling whether the capacitor module, the battery module, or a combination of the capacitor module and the battery module is coupled to the generator output terminal in response to a received signal.

(14) In some aspects, the mechanical input comprises a flywheel configured to store mechanical energy received from the driven mass and the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, wherein the shaft is coupled to the second side, and wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft in the first direction of rotation and together with the shaft in the second direction of rotation. In some aspects, the method further comprises supporting, via an independent suspension, the driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber.

(15) In another aspect, an apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The apparatus further comprises a driven mass configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate and a generator configured to generate an electrical output at a generator output terminal

based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate. The apparatus further comprises a hardware controller configured to: convey at least a first portion of the electrical output to one of a capacitor module, a battery, and a motor of the vehicle, each of the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor selectively coupled to the generator output terminal, disconnect the generator output terminal from the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor in response to an interrupt signal received, initiate a dump of a residual electrical energy in the generator for a period of time, and connect the generator output terminal to one of the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor of the vehicle after the period of time expires. The interrupt signal is generated by a controller in response to one or more conditions.

(16) In some aspects, the interrupt signal is received at periodic intervals defined based on at least one of a period of time following a previous interrupt signal, a distance traveled by the vehicle, a speed of the vehicle, and a power generated by the generator. In some aspects, the hardware controller is further configured to dump the residual electrical energy comprises the hardware controller being configured to: electrically couple the generator output terminal to a dump load for the period of time, and disconnect the generator output terminal from the dump load after the period of time passes, wherein the dump load comprises one or more of a back-up battery or capacitor.

(17) In another aspect, a method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The method comprises rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, generating an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate, conveying at least a first portion of the electrical output to one of a capacitor module, a battery, and a motor of the vehicle selectively coupled to the generator output terminal, disconnecting the generator output terminal from the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor in response to an interrupt signal received, dumping a residual electrical energy in the generator for a period of time, and connecting the generator output terminal to one of the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor of the vehicle after the period of time expires, wherein the interrupt signal is generated by a controller in response to one or more conditions.

(18) In some aspects, the interrupt signal is received at periodic intervals defined based on at least one of a period of time following a previous interrupt signal, a distance traveled by the vehicle, a speed of the vehicle, and a power generated by the generator. In some aspects, dumping the residual electrical energy comprises: electrically coupling the generator output terminal to a dump load for the period of time and disconnecting the generator output terminal from the dump load after the period of time passes, wherein the dump load comprises one or more of a back-up battery or capacitor.

(19) In another aspect, an apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The apparatus comprises a motor configured to place the vehicle in motion, a driven mass configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle generated when the vehicle is in motion, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, and a generator configured to generate an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on rotation of a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate. The apparatus further comprises a capacitor module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal and configured to: receive a portion of the electrical output generated by the generator, store the portion of the electrical output as an electric field of the capacitor module when the battery has a charge that exceeds a threshold value, and convey the first energy to a load of the vehicle on demand. The apparatus further comprises a hardware controller configured to control the motor, the generator, and coupling of the capacitor module to the generator module, wherein the electrical output

generated is greater than or equal to a consumption of the motor of the vehicle when the vehicle is in motion.

(20) In another aspect, a method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle is disclosed. The method comprises rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, generating, by a generator, an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on rotation of a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate, conveying a portion of the electrical output to a capacitor module selectively coupled to the generator output terminal with a battery of the vehicle, and storing the portion of the electrical output in the capacitor module when the battery has a charge that exceeds a threshold value, wherein the electrical output generated by the generator is greater than or equal to a consumption of a motor of the vehicle when the vehicle is in motion.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an exemplary battery electric vehicle (BEV).
- (2) FIG. 2 is a diagram of an exemplary “fifth” wheel configured to drive or power an on-board charging system (OBCS) capable of charging an energy storage device of the BEV of FIG. 1.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a diagram of the fifth wheel of FIG. 2 mechanically coupled to two generators that convert a mechanical rotation of the fifth wheel into electrical energy outputs.
- (4) FIG. 4 is an alternate view of the two generators of FIG. 3 and cabling that couples the generators to a mobile battery charger coupled to a charging port for the BEV.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a diagram of the exemplary BEV of FIG. 1 incorporating one or more capacitor modules as a supplemental and/or intermediate energy storage device.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a diagram of the coupling of the fifth wheel and the two generators of FIG. 3 with the addition of a capacitor module into the charging system of the BEV.
- (7) FIG. 7 is an alternate fifth wheel system illustrating the fifth wheel of FIG. 2 mechanically coupled to a generation unit that converts a mechanical rotation of the fifth wheel into an electrical energy output.
- (8) FIGS. 8A and 8B provide additional views of the alternate fifth wheel system of FIG. 7.
- (9) FIG. 9 illustrates a close-up view of the stabilization bracket between the generation unit and the flywheel of FIG. 7.
- (10) FIGS. 10A-10P are screenshots of an interface that presents various variables that are monitored during operation of the EV with an example embodiment of the OBCS described herein.
- (11) FIGS. 11A-11B depict different views of an example embodiment of components of a bearing support that supports a rotating element, the bearing support including a bearing enclosure and a bearing assembly.
- (12) FIG. 12A-12C depict different views of the bearing assembly of FIGS. 11A-11B, including a plurality of bearings, a bearing spacer, and a shaft.
- (13) FIG. 13 shows a top-down view of the bearing spacer of the bearing assembly of FIGS. 11A-12C.
- (14) FIGS. 14A-14C show different views of a partial construction of the bearing assembly of FIGS. 12A-12C, the partial construction including a first bearing, the bearing spacer, and the shaft.
- (15) The various features illustrated in the drawings may not be drawn to scale. Accordingly, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily expanded or reduced for clarity. In addition, some of the drawings may not depict all of the components of a given system, method or device. Finally, like reference numerals may be used to denote like features throughout the specification and figures.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(16) The detailed description set forth below in connection with the appended drawings is intended as a description of exemplary embodiments and is not intended to represent the only embodiments in which the invention may be practiced. The term “exemplary” used throughout this description means “serving as an example, instance, or illustration,” and should not necessarily be construed as preferred or advantageous over other exemplary embodiments. The detailed description includes specific details for providing a thorough understanding of the exemplary embodiments. In some instances, some devices are shown in block diagram form.

(17) An electric vehicle (EV) is used herein to describe a vehicle that includes, as at least part of its locomotion capabilities, electrical power derived from energy sources (e.g., one or more energy generation devices and energy storage devices, for example rechargeable electrochemical cells, capacitors, ultra-capacitors, other types of batteries, and other energy storage devices). In some embodiments, capacitor (or ultra-capacitor modules) may be ideal replacements for the battery 102 where long term storage for energy generated by the generators 302a and 302b is not needed but an ability to quickly store and discharge large amounts of energy is desired. As non-limiting examples, some EVs may be hybrid electric vehicles (HEVs) that include, besides electric motors, one or more batteries, and a traditional combustion engine for direct locomotion or to charge the vehicle's battery. Other EVs, for example battery electric vehicles (BEVs), may draw all locomotion capability from electrical power stored in a battery. An EV is not limited to an automobile and may include motorcycles, carts, scooters, buses, and the like. Additionally, EVs are not limited to any particular energy source (e.g., energy storage source or generation source) or to when the electricity is received from the energy source (for example, when the EV is at rest or in motion).

(18) Current EVs, whether HEVs or BEVs, may be charged using stationary charging stations. Such stationary charging stations may be installed at home or in public locations, such as public parking lots, along roadways, and so forth. These stationary charging stations may use cables that couple to the EVs to convey charging power between the EVs and the stationary charging stations and/or use wireless transfer technologies to wirelessly convey charging power between the EVs and the stationary charging stations. The “stationary” aspect of charging stations may refer to the static nature of the charging stations themselves. For example, such stationary charging stations themselves are generally permanently (or semi-permanently) installed in fixed locations because of needed power feeds required to provide electricity to the charging stations (for example, a connection to a home panel for the home installation) and, therefore, require power from a power grid, thereby increasing burdens on the power grid. In some embodiments, the EVs themselves receive a charge from the stationary charging stations while the EVs are stationary (for example, parked in a parking spot) or in motion (for example, driving over or in proximity of one or more wireless charging components of the stationary charging stations while the EVs are in motion).

(19) In some embodiments, an EV owner may utilize a generator to charge the EV. For example, the generator is a mobile generator that the EV owner is able to transport to various locations in order to charge the EV. In some embodiments, such mobile generators provide a charge to the EV when the EV does not have sufficient power to drive to a stationary charging station or to provide any charge at a location where a stationary charging station is not available. Additionally, or alternatively, the mobile generator may provide charging to the EV while the EV is in motion. However, such mobile generators often utilize gasoline or other fuels to generate electricity from a chemical and/or mechanical reaction. Therefore, use of the mobile generators may involve transporting the fuel for the generator and/or waiting for a charge provided by the mobile generators and generation of harmful byproducts that must be exhausted from the vehicle. Additionally, the mobile generators are generally unable to provide a charge at a rate greater than charge used to drive the EV. For example, the mobile generator is only able to provide hourly charging rates at the equivalent of providing electricity to allow the EV to travel between 4 miles and 25 miles while the moving EV will generally consume more electricity than this in an hour of

travel. Such charging rates would be insufficient to maintain motion of the EV during use. Alternatively, or additionally, the EV owner may use a portable battery charger or other portable energy storage device that is able to transfer energy to the EV when the EV is unable to drive to a stationary charging station. Such use of portable battery chargers may involve similar constraints as the mobile generators, such as charge transfer times, and so forth. The user may also use regenerative braking or regenerative driving (for example, generating electricity while the vehicle is in motion and not necessarily braking) to charge or power the EV. For example, a regenerative driving system may generate electricity based on movement of one or more vehicle components that is moving or driven while the EV is moving.

(20) Accordingly, the disclosure described in more detail herein provides an on-board charging system (OBCS) that charges the energy storage device (for example, the battery, the battery array, the energy containment device, or similar) or provides electricity directly to motors of the EV while the EV is in motion (or generally traveling) at a charging rate sufficient to enable significant, continued use of the EV while the EV is charging. Some embodiments incorporate a battery charger or other generator that is capable of providing charge to the energy storage device of the EV or the motors of the EV at a rate greater than that which the EV is able to discharge the energy storage device. The OBCS may be mobile in the sense that it moves with the EV while being fixedly attached to the EV. Alternatively, or additionally, the OBCS may be removable from the EV and portable to other EVs, and so forth. In some embodiments, the OBCS provides stable and consistent power on demand for the EV, thereby extending a travel range of the EV. The EV (for example, via a controller and/or communications with the OBCS) may request the OBCS to charge the EV by providing the electrical power needed at any given moment. This may be, and in fact is intended to be, a cyclical process as the EV drains its energy storage device and requests additional charge from the OBCS. Alternatively, the EV may communicate with the OBCS to provide electrical power directly to the motors of the EV, bypassing the energy storage device of the EV. The OBCS may reduce reliance of charging of EVs using grid charging and may significantly reduce the mining of fossil fuels and resulting carbon emissions.

(21) Further details regarding the OBCS and its integration with the EV are provided below with reference to FIGS. 1-14C and corresponding description.

(22) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an exemplary battery electric vehicle (BEV) **100**, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment. The BEV **100** includes, among other components shown, a battery **102**, at least one electric motor **104**, a plurality of wheels **106**, and a frame or body **108**. The battery **102** may include a plurality of individual battery units or modules and may store energy used to drive the at least one electric motor **104**. In some embodiments, the individual battery units may be coupled in series to provide a greater voltage for the battery **102** than an individual battery unit. In some embodiments, the battery **102** includes any other charge or energy storage or containment device. In some embodiments, the battery **102** is coupled to a controller (not shown, for example the EV controller) configured to monitor a charge state or a charge value of the battery **102**. The controller may provide controls for how the battery **102** is charged or discharged and may provide various signals, interlocks, and so forth with respect to the battery **102**. For example, the controller may limit charging of the battery **102** in certain weather conditions, vehicle conditions or states, or based on one or more interlocks (such as when a charging port door is left open, and so forth).

(23) In some embodiments, each of the battery units (and the battery **102** as a whole) may exist in one of a plurality of charge states, including a fully charged state, a fully discharged state, a charging state, a sufficient charge state, a discharging state, and a charge desired state, among others. The controller, based on its monitoring of the charge states of the individual battery units and the battery **102** and/or a voltage of the battery **102**, may allow the battery **102** to provide power to a load, for example the motor **104**, request charging of the battery **102**, or prevent one or more of charging and/or discharging of the battery **102** based on the charge states. Thus, if the battery **102** is discharged below a threshold charge value (for example, if the battery **102** is in the charge desired

state), then the controller may prevent further discharge of the battery **102** and/or request that the battery **102** be charged. Alternatively, or additionally, if the battery **102** is receiving charge from a charger and the charge value of the battery **102** exceeds a threshold full charge value (for example, if the battery **102** is in the fully charged state), then the controller may prevent further charging of the battery **102**.

(24) The battery **102** provides electrical energy to the at least one motor **104**. The at least one motor **104** converts the electrical energy to mechanical energy to rotate one or more of the plurality of wheels **106**, thus causing the BEV **100** to move. In some embodiments, the at least one motor **104** is coupled to two or more of the plurality of wheels **106**. In some embodiments, the at least one motor **104** includes two motors **104** that each power a single wheel **106** of the plurality of wheels **106**. In some embodiments, the controller monitors the state of the at least one motor **104**, for example whether the at least one motor **104** is driving at least one of the plurality of wheels **106** to cause the BEV **100** to move based on energy from the battery **102**, and so forth. In some embodiments, the controller may monitor a direction in which the at least one wheel **106** is rotating.

(25) The BEV **100** may be configured to use the wheel(s) **106**, the motor(s) **104**, and the battery **102** to charge the battery **102** using regenerative braking from a generative braking system (not shown). Regenerative braking enables the BEV **100** to capture energy from the rotation of the wheel(s) **106** for storage in the battery **102** when the BEV **100** is coasting (for example, moving with using energy from the battery **102** to power the motor(s) **104** to drive the wheel(s) **106**) and/or braking. Regenerative braking effectively charges the BEV **100** based on kinetic energy of the BEV **100**. Effectively, the motor(s) **104** convert the kinetic energy from the moving BEV **100** to electrical energy for storage in the battery **102**, causing the BEV **100** to slow. In some embodiments, the controller may be used to control operation of the motor(s) **104** efficiently and effectively to enable regenerative braking when the motor(s) **104** is not being used to drive the wheel(s). For example, the controller may determine that the motor **104** is not being used to drive the corresponding wheel **106** and may switch the motor **104** into a regenerative braking mode or state to capture charge from the movement of the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, if the controller determines that at least one wheel **106** is rotating at a speed faster than a speed at which it is being driving (for example, when the BEV is going down a steep hill), then the controller controls the motor **104** to perform regenerative braking or otherwise regenerate charge from the movement of the BEV. In some embodiments, the controller generates one or more alerts for display to a driver or operator of the BEV **100** or communicated to an internal or external system (for example, about charging needs, battery levels, regenerative braking, and so forth).

(26) Though not explicitly shown in FIG. 1, the BEV **100** may include a charging port that allows the battery **102** to be connected to a power source for charging. Often, the charging port allows connection of a plug external to the BEV **100** that is then connected to an external power source, such as a wall charger, and so forth. In some embodiments, internal wiring couples the charging port to the battery **102** to allow for charging. Alternatively, or additionally, the BEV **100** includes a wireless power antenna configured to receive and/or transmit power wirelessly. As such, internal wiring couples the wireless power antenna to the battery **102** to allow for charging. In some embodiments, the internal wiring may couple either the charging port and/or the wireless power antenna directly to the motor **104**. The controller may detect when the battery **102** is receiving a charge via the charging port and/or the wireless power antenna.

(27) FIG. 2 is a diagram of an exemplary “fifth” wheel **202** configured to drive or power an on-board charging system (OBCS) **210** capable of charging the battery **102** of the BEV **100** of FIG. 1, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment. The fifth wheel **202** as shown is in an extended state such that the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the ground or road surface and, thus, rotates while the BEV **100** is in motion. The controller may extend or retract the fifth wheel **202** such that the fifth wheel **202** is not always in contact with the ground or road surface. In some embodiments, the

fifth wheel **202** is replaced with or integrated as a small motor or geared component driven by a drive shaft, motor **104**, wheel **106**, or other driven component of the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, the small motor or geared component may include a small fixed gear electric motor that rotates the shaft at a desirable rotations per minute (RPM). For discussion herein, the fifth wheel **202** will be described as being driven when in contact with the ground, though any other means of being driven (for example, the small motor or geared component driven by a drive shaft) is envisioned. As such, the fifth wheel **202**, whether in contact with the ground or integrated with another drive component within the BEV **100**, rotates in response to the BEV **100** being driven to move or otherwise moving. In some embodiments, although the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the ground, the fifth wheel **202** may not carry a significant portion of weight of the BEV **100**. As such, in some embodiments, a minimal or small amount of drag will be created or caused by the fifth wheel **202**. The controller may be configured to control the amount of drag that the fifth wheel **202** creates (for example, how much pressure the fifth wheel **202** exerts downward on the road surface).

(28) The fifth wheel **202** is coupled to a drive shaft (herein referred to as the “shaft”) **206**. As the fifth wheel **202** rotates, the shaft **206** also rotates at a same, similar, or corresponding rate as the fifth wheel **202**. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** and the shaft **206** may be coupled such that the shaft **206** rotates at a greater or reduced rate as compared to the fifth wheel **202**. In some embodiments, the shaft **206** is coupled to a support structure **200**. The support structure **200** may be attached to the frame or body **108** of the BEV **100** and allow for the fifth wheel **202** to be extended or retracted as needed while supported by the BEV **100**. Two sprockets or gears **208a** and **208b** are disposed on the shaft **206** such that when the shaft **206** rotates, the sprockets **208a** and **208b** also rotate. In some embodiments, the sprockets **208a** and **208b** and the shaft **206** may be coupled such that the sprockets **208a** and **208b** rotate at a greater or reduced rate as compared to the shaft **206**.

(29) The sprockets **208a** and **208b** engage with a chain, belt, gearing, pulley, or similar device **204a** and **204b**, respectively. The chains **204a** and **204b** cause one or more devices (not shown in this figure) coupled via the chains **204a** and **204b** to rotate at a rate that corresponds to the rate of rotation of the sprockets **208a** and **208b**. In some embodiments, the one or more devices coupled to the sprockets **208a** and **208b** via the chains, gearing, pulley, or similar device **204a** and **204b** are components of or otherwise coupled to the OBCS **210**. For example, the devices to which the sprockets **208a** and **208b** are coupled via the chains (and so forth) **204a** and **204b** provide power (for example, by way of kinetic energy) to the OBCS **210** to enable the OBCS **210** to charge the BEV **100** while the BEV **100** is in motion. Thus, in some embodiments, the devices to which the sprockets **208a** and **208b** are coupled via the chains **204a** and **204b** may include generators, alternators, or similar mechanical to electrical energy conversion devices, as described in further detail below. In some embodiments, the small motor described above may act as a fail over motor to drive the shaft driving the generators **302a** and **302b** should one of the chains **204a** and **204b** fail.

(30) In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** includes any existing, off the shelf BEV charger or a custom developed BEV charger, such as a level 1 electric vehicle charger, a level 2 electric vehicle charger, a level 3 electric vehicle charger, and so forth. The OBCS **210** may couple to the charging port of the BEV **100**, thereby allowing the OBCS **210** to charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100**. Alternatively, the OBCS **210** may provide charge wirelessly to the wireless power antenna of the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** may be used in conjunction with power received via the charging port when the OBCS **210** provides power via the wireless power antenna or in conjunction with power received via the wireless power antenna when the OBCS **210** provides power via the charging port. Thus, charging by an external system (for example, stationary charging systems) may occur in conjunction with charging by the OBCS **210**.

(31) The level one charger generates a charge for the battery **102** of the BEV **100** based on a 120-volt (V) alternating current (AC) connection, which is generally referred to as a standard household

wall outlet. Charge times with the level 1 charger are generally longer than those for other chargers. Generally, the level one charger may charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100** at a rate of 4-8 miles per hour (MPH) of charging. The level 2 charger generates the charge for the battery **102** of the BEV **100** based on a 240V AC connection. Charge times with the level 2 charger are generally much quicker than those with the level one charger but slower than the level 3 charger. The level 2 charger may generally charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100** at a rate of 15-30 miles per hour of charging. The level 3 charger generates the charge for the battery **102** of the BEV **100** based on a 480V direct current (DC) connection. Charge times with the level 3 charger are generally much quicker than those with the level 2 charger. The level 3 charger may generally charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100** at a rate of 45+ miles per half-hour of charging. Higher level chargers may provide greater levels of energy to the BEV **100** to allow the battery **102** to be charged at faster rates than even the level 3 charger.

(32) In some embodiments, the BEV **100** includes multiple fifth wheels **202**, sprockets **208**, and/or chains **204** coupling the sprockets **208** to one or more devices. The one or more fifth wheels **202** and the corresponding one or more sprockets **208** may rotate with one or more corresponding shafts **206**. In some embodiments, each fifth wheel **202** is mounted via its respective shaft **206** to its own support structure **200**. In some embodiments, each fifth wheel **202**, when additional fifth wheels **202** exist, is coupled to its own energy conversion device(s) through one or more sprockets **208** and chains **204** that rotate with the corresponding shaft **206** of the additional fifth wheels **202**. By including additional fifth wheels **202**, more mechanical energy may be converted to electrical energy for supply by the OBCS **210** as compared to with a single fifth wheel **202**.

(33) FIG. **3** is a diagram of the fifth wheel **202** of FIG. **2** mechanically coupled to two generators **302a** and **302b** that convert mechanical rotation of the fifth wheel **202** into electrical energy outputs, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment. In some embodiments, the generators **302a** and **302b** may be replaced with alternators or similar electricity generating devices. Each of the generators **302a** and **302b** has a rotor coupled to a drive pulley **304a** and **304b**, respectively. The drive pulley **304** of each generator **302** may rotate, causing the corresponding rotor to rotate and causing the generators **302** to generate an electrical energy output via a cable (not shown in this figure). The drive pulleys **304a** and **304b** are coupled to the fifth wheel **202** via one of the sprockets **208a** and **208b** and one of the chains **204a** and **204b**, respectively. The cable may supply any generated electrical energy output to the OBCS **210** as an input energy to the OBCS **210**. In some embodiments, the two generators **302a** and **302b** may be replaced by any number of generators **302**, from a single generator to many generators. In some embodiments, the generators **302** may generate AC electricity or DC electricity, depending on the application. When the generators **302** generate AC power, an AC-to-DC converter may be used to condition and convert the generated electricity for storage. When the generators **302** generate DC power, an DC-to-DC converter may be used to condition the generated electricity for storage.

(34) As described above, the fifth wheel **202** is designed to rotate when the BEV **100** is in motion and the fifth wheel **202** is extended and/or otherwise in contact with the ground or road surface (or otherwise being driven while the BEV is in motion). When the fifth wheel **202** rotates, that rotation causes the shaft **206** to rotate, causing the sprockets **208a** and **208b** to also rotate. Accordingly, the chains **204a** and **204b** coupled to the sprockets **208a** and **208b** move or rotate around the sprockets **208a** and **208b**, respectively. The movement of the chains **204a** and **204b** while the BEV **100** is in motion and the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the ground causes the pulleys **304a** and **304b** of the rotors of the generators **302a** and **302b**, respectively, to rotate. As described above, the rotation of the pulleys **304** of the generators **302** causes the rotors of the generators **302** to rotate to cause the generators **302** to generate the electrical energy output via the cable, where the electrical energy output corresponds to the mechanical rotation of the pulleys **304**. Thus, rotation of the fifth wheel **202** causes the generators **302a** and **302b** to generate electrical energy outputs. In some embodiments, the generators **302a** and **302b** (in combination and/or individually) may generate

electrical energy outputs at greater than 400 VAC (for example in a range between 120 VAC and 480 VAC) delivering up to or more than 120 kW of power to the OBCS **210**. In some embodiments, the power output of the generators **302a** and **302b**, in combination and/or individually, may range between 1.2 kilowatts (kW) and 120 kW, for example 1.2 kW, 3.3 kW, 6.6 kW, 22 kW, 26 kW, 62.5 kW, and 120 kW, and so forth. In some embodiments, the generators **302a** and **302b** provide up to or more than 150 kW of power. The power provided by the generators may be adjusted by adjusting the particular generators used or by otherwise limiting an amount of power being delivered from the OBCS **210** to the battery **102** (or similar charge storage devices), as needed.

(35) In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** may be designed to be smaller in diameter than the wheels **106** of the BEV **100**. By making the fifth wheel **202** smaller in diameter than the wheels **106** of the BEV **100**, the fifth wheel **202** may rotate more revolutions per distance traveled than the wheels **106**. Accordingly, the fifth wheel **202** rotates at a faster RPM than the wheels **106**. The shaft **206**, coupled to the fifth wheel **202**, has a smaller diameter than the fifth wheel **202**. The sprockets **208a** and **208b** coupled to the shaft **206** have a larger diameter than the shaft **206** but a smaller diameter than the fifth wheel **202**. In some embodiments, the diameters of the various components (for example, the fifth wheel **202**, the shaft **206** and/or the sprockets **208a** and **208b**) may be varied to further increase the rate of rotation (or rotational speed) of the corresponding components. In some embodiments, the diameter of the fifth wheel **202** may be reduced further as compared to the wheels **106**. In some embodiments, gearing between the fifth wheel **202** and the shaft **206** and/or between the shaft **206** and the sprockets **208a** and **208b** may further increase the difference in the rotational rates or speeds of the various components as compared to the wheel **106**.

(36) As shown in FIG. 3, the pulleys **304** (and the rotors) of the generators **302** have a smaller diameter than the sprockets **208**. Accordingly, the pulleys **304** may rotate at a faster or greater RPM than the sprockets **208** and the fifth wheel **202**. Accordingly, the rotors of the generators **302** coupled to the pulleys **304** may rotate at a faster RPM (as compared to the fifth wheel **202**) and generate electrical energy that is output to the OBCS **210** via the cable described above. In some embodiments, adjusting the diameters of the various components described herein to cause the pulleys **304a** and **304b** to rotate at different RPMs and can cause the generators **302a** and **302b** to generate different amounts of power for transmission to the OBCS **210** (for example, faster rotation may result in more power generated by the generators **302a** and **302b** than slower rotation). By varying the sizing of the various components, the rotors of the generators **302a** and **302b** may rotate at greater or smaller rotation rates. The greater the rotational rate, the more power that is generated by the generators **302a** and **302b**. Thus, to maximize power generation by the generators **302a** and **302b**, the various components (for example, the fifth wheel **202**, the shaft **206**, the sprockets **208**, the pulleys **304**, and so forth), may be sized to maximize the rotation rate of and power generated by the generators **302**.

(37) In some embodiments, the wheels **106** of the BEV **100** may be between 15" and 22" in diameter, inclusive. Specifically, the wheels **106** of the BEV **100** may be 15", 16", 17", 18", 19", 20", 21", or 22" in diameter. The corresponding fifth wheel **202** may be between 7" and 13", inclusive. Specifically, the fifth wheel **202** may be 7", 8", 9", 10", 11", 12", or 13" in diameter. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** has a diameter selected such that the ratio of the diameter of the wheel **106** to the diameter of the fifth wheel **202** meets a certain threshold value (for example, 1.5:1, 1.6:1, 1.7:1, 1.8:1, 1.9:1, 2:1, 3:1, 15:1 and so forth). This means that the fifth wheel **202** may rotate at a speed such that a ratio of the rotation speed of the fifth wheel **202** to the rotation speed of the wheel **106** is the same as the ratio between the diameter of the fifth wheel **202** to the diameter of the wheel **106**.

(38) In some embodiments, the sprockets **208a** and **208b** may have a diameter that is approximately half the diameter of the fifth wheel **202**. For example, a ratio of the diameter of the fifth wheel **202** to the sprockets **208a** and **208b** may be approximately 2:1 such that the sprockets

208a and **208b** rotate at approximately twice the rotational speed or RPMs as the fifth wheel **202**. More specifically, the diameter of the sprockets **208a** and **208b** may be between 3" and 5", where the diameter is one of 3", 4", and 5". Similarly, the sprockets **208a** and **208b** may have a larger diameter than the pulleys **304a** and **304b**; for example, the pulleys **304a** and **304b** may have diameters of less than 5" (more specifically, one or more of 1", 2", 3", 4", and 5", inclusive. The resulting rotation of the pulleys **304a** and **304b** occurs at sufficiently high, sustained speeds or RPMs that the corresponding generators **302a** and **302b** generate electrical power at levels sufficient to energy the OBCS **210** to charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100** while the BEV **100** is in motion.

(39) As the rotors for the generators **302a** and **302b** rotate, they induce a magnetic field within windings in stator coils of the generators **302a** and **302b**. The magnetic field generated within the coils may be controlled (for example, increased or decreased) by changing a number of coils in each of the generators **302a** and **302b**, thus changing the sizing of the generators **302a** and **302b**. The energy generated by the generators **302a** and **302** may be varied (for example, increased or decreased) by introducing and/or changing a number of capacitors or other components utilized in conjunction with the generators **302a** and **302b** (for example, within the generators **302a** and **302b** or in series downstream of the generators **302a** and **302b**), and/or by using a permanent magnet coil in the generators **302**. The magnetic field generated within the coils may be directly related to the energy (for example, a current) generated by the generators **302a** and **302b**. In some embodiments, the magnetic field is related to the torque on the generator such that as the torque on the generator increases, the magnetic field rises. As such, to reduce wear and tear on components in the BEV **100** and to optimize voltage generation, the magnetic field is managed as described herein. In some embodiments, when the fifth wheel **202** comprises the small motor as described above, the small motor is an AC or DC motor and acts as a fail over device that is coupled directly to the rotors of the generators **302** such that the small motor is able to drive the generator should the pulley **204**, the fifth wheel **202**, or other device coupling the fifth wheel **202** to the generators **302** fail.

(40) FIG. 4 is an alternate view of the two generators **302a** and **302b** of FIG. 3 and cabling **402a** and **402b** that couples the generators **302a** and **302b** to a battery charger **403** coupled to a charging port for the BEV **100**, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment. The generators **302a** and **302b** are shown with cables **402a** and **402b**, respectively, that couple the generators **302a** and **302b** to the battery charger **403**. The OBCS **210** may include the battery charger **403** described herein. The battery charger **403** may comprise one or more other components or circuits used to rectify or otherwise condition the electricity generated by the generators **302a** and **302b**. For example, the one or more other components or circuits may comprise one or more of a matching circuit, an inverter circuit, a conditioning circuit, a rectifying circuit, a conversion circuit, and so forth. The matching circuit may matching conditions of a load to the source (for example, impedance matching, and so forth). The conversion circuit may comprise a circuit that converts an alternating current (AC) signal to a direct current (DC) signal, a DC/DC conversion circuit, a DC/AC conversion circuit and so forth. The conditioning circuit may condition a signal input into the conditioning circuit, and the rectifying circuit may rectify signals. In some embodiments, the support structure **200** may be mounted to the BEV **100** with a shock system or springs **404** to assist with reducing impacts of the road, etc., on the BEV **100** and/or the OBCS **210**.

(41) In some embodiments, a rate of rotation of seven hundred (700) revolutions or rotations per minute (RPM) for the fifth wheel **202** identifies a lowest threshold RPM of the fifth wheel **202** at which the generators **302a** and **302b** will provide sufficient electrical power to charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100** via the OBCS **210**. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** may rotate at 3,600 or 10,000 RPM or the generators **302a** and **302b** (and/or the generator unit **710** described below) may rotate at 3,600 or 10,000 RPM. Furthermore, at or above 700 RPMs for the fifth wheel **202**, the fifth wheel **202** (and/or any coupled flywheel) may be capable of maintaining its rate of rotation (for example, the 700 RPMs) even if the fifth wheel **202** it not kept in contact with the

ground or road surface while the BEV **100** is moving. For example, the fifth wheel **202** may have a driven mass (referenced herein as “mass”) of between 15 and 75 kilograms (for example, one of 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, and 75 kilograms and so forth, or any value therebetween) and the mass may enable the fifth wheel **202** to continue to rotate when not driven by the contact with the ground due to inertia of the fifth wheel **202**. For example, once the fifth wheel **202** reaches at least 700 RPMs, the fifth wheel **202** may be retracted from contact with the ground or road surface and continue to rotate at at least 700 RPMs based on the inertia of the fifth wheel **202** (and/or any coupled flywheel), enabling the generators **302a** and **302b** to continue generating power to charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100** when the fifth wheel **202** is retracted. Furthermore, at fifth wheel **202** RPMs greater than or equal to 700 RPMs, the corresponding diameters of the components between the fifth wheel **202** and the generators **302a** and **302b** (for example, the sprockets **208a** and **208b**, the pulleys **304a** and **304b**, and so forth) cause the generators **302a** and **302b** to generate sufficient power (for example, between 1.2 kW and 120 kW or more) to charge the battery **102** of the BEV **100** using the battery charger **403** at a rate that is greater than a discharge rate of the battery **102** driving the motor **104** and wheels **106** of the BEV **100** to keep the BEV **100** in motion. Thus, at fifth wheel **202** speeds of at least 700 RPM, the generators **302a** and **302b** generate sufficient electrical energy to replenish the battery **102** as the motors **104** and the wheels **106** move the BEV **100** and drain battery **102**. Thus, the fifth wheel **202** may be used to regenerate the battery **102** while the BEV **100** is in motion, therefore extending a range of the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** enables the harvesting of mechanical energy from the movement of the BEV **100** before the such energy is lost to heat or friction, and so forth. Thus, the OBCS **210**, as described herein, may convert kinetic energy that may otherwise be lost to electrical energy for consumption by the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, the generators **302a** and/or **302b** may each generate a voltage of up to 580 VAC when driven by the fifth wheel **202**, for example at the rotational speed of between about 700 and 10,000 RPM.

(42) In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** or other small motor may be coupled to a flywheel (not shown in this figure) that is configured to generate the inertia used to store kinetic energy of the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, the flywheel may be selectively coupled to the fifth wheel **202** or other small motor to allow the flywheel to be selectively engaged with the fifth wheel **202**, for example when the BEV **100** is slowing down, when the BEV **100** is accelerating, and so forth. Additionally, the flywheel may be coupled to the fifth wheel **202** via a clutch or similar coupling to allow the flywheel to be driven by the fifth wheel **202** or small motor but not allow the flywheel to drive the fifth wheel **202** or small motor. When the flywheel is included, the flywheel may have a mass of between 15 and 75 kilograms (for example, one of 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, and 75 kilograms and so forth, or any value therebetween).

(43) In some embodiments, the one or more other components or circuits (e.g., the capacitors, matching, filtering, rectifying, and so forth, circuits) clean, convert, and/or condition the electricity provided by the generators **302a** and **302b** before the electricity reaches the battery charger **403** and/or motor **104**. For example, cleaning and/or conditioning the electricity may comprise filtering the electricity or matching of values between a load and a source. Converting the electricity may comprise converting an AC signal to a DC signal, or vice versa (for example, converting an AC signal generated by the generators **302a** and **302b** to a DC signal for storage in the battery **102** or similar energy storage device. Cleaning, converting, and/or conditioning the electricity provided to the battery charger **403** may help maintain operation of the battery charger **403** and reduce fluctuations in the quality of electricity consumed by the battery charger **403** to charge the battery **102** or drive the motors **104** or the motors **104** to drive the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, the battery charger **403** may be selectively coupled directly to the motor **104** instead of having to feed electricity through the battery **102** to then feed the motor **104**. Cleaning the energy provided to the battery charger **403** or the motor **104** may also reduce risk of damage to the battery charger **403** and/or the motor **104** that may be caused by the electricity from the generators **302a** and **302b**. In

some embodiments, one or more of the circuits described above may reduce and/or control variance in the electricity generated by the generators **302a** and **302b**. Similarly, changes in the generators **302a** and **302b** (for example, inclusion of different circuits in the generators **302a** and **302b** themselves) may cause the generators **302a** and **302b** to reduce and/or control variance of the magnetic fields generated in and the electricity generated by the generators **302a** and **302b**. In some embodiments, the battery charger **403** may be synchronized with the generators **302a** and **302b** (or other similar generator units).

(44) In some embodiments, the extending and retracting of the fifth wheel **202** may occur based on communications with the controller that monitors the state of charge of the battery **102** and/or demand from the motor **104**. For example, when the controller determines that the battery **102** requires a charge or the motor demands electricity (for example, the BEV **100** is accelerating), the controller issues a signal to a fifth wheel **202** control system that causes the fifth wheel **202** to be extended to be in contact with the ground or road surface while the BEV **100** is in motion. Once the fifth wheel **202** reaches an RPM of at least 700 RPM, the rate of rotation (for example, the RPMs) of the fifth wheel **202** may be controlled and/or monitored such that the battery **102** is charged such that the charge of the battery **102** is maintained or increased or such that the motor **104** is provided with sufficient energy to drive the BEV **100**. For example, if the controller determines that the battery **102** needs to be charged while the BEV **100** is in motion, the controller may issue the signal to charge the battery **102** to the fifth wheel **202** system. This signal may cause the fifth wheel **202** system to extend the fifth wheel **202** to contact the ground or road surface. When the fifth wheel **202** reaches 700 RPM while the BEV **100** is moving, the generators **302a** and **302b** generate sufficient electrical energy to charge the battery **102** at a rate greater than it is being discharged by the motor **104** to move the BEV **100** or to feed the motor **104** at a level sufficient to fully drive the BEV **100**. As the controller monitors the charge of the battery **102** or the demand from the motor **104**, when the charge level or the charge state of the battery **102** or the motor demand **104** reaches a second threshold, the controller may issue a second signal to stop charging the battery **102** or stop feeding the motor **104**. This second signal may cause the fifth wheel **202** to be retracted or otherwise disconnect the feed of electricity from the battery **102** or the motor **104**.

(45) In some embodiments, retracting the fifth wheel **202** occurs in a controlled matter. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** continues to rotate when it is initially retracted and no longer in contact with the ground or road surface. As such, the generators **302a** and **302b** coupled to the fifth wheel **202** continue to generate electrical energy while the fifth wheel **202** continues to rotate based on its inertia. The controller may issue the second signal before the battery **102** is fully charged so as to not waste any energy generated by the generators **302a** and **302b**. In some embodiments, energy generated by the generators **302a** and **302b** may be offloaded from the BEV **100**, for example to a land-based grid or energy storage device (for example, a home battery, and so forth).

(46) In some embodiments, the controlled deceleration of the rotation of the fifth wheel **202** when the fifth wheel **202** is retracted occurs due to a brake or similar component that causes the fifth wheel **202** to stop rotating in a controlled manner. In some embodiments, the brake may include a physical brake or other slowing techniques. In some embodiments, the braking of the fifth wheel **202** is regenerative to provide energy to the battery **102** or the motor **104** while the fifth wheel **202** is braking.

(47) In some embodiments, as described above, the fifth wheel **202** extends in response to the first signal from the controller requesting that the battery **102** of the BEV **100** be charged. As noted above, the fifth wheel **202** may have a mass that allows the fifth wheel **202** to continue to rotate under inertia, etc., when the fifth wheel **202** is retracted and no longer in contact with the ground or road surface while the BEV is in motion. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** is coupled to the flywheel or similar component that spins under the inertia, etc., after the fifth wheel **202** is retracted from the ground or road surface. Based on the inertia of the fifth wheel **202** or the flywheel or similar component, mechanical energy may be generated from the movement of the

BEV **100** and stored for conversion to electricity (for example, by the generators **302a** and **302b**, etc.).

(48) Once the fifth wheel **202** is extended to contact the ground or road surface, the fifth wheel **202** begins rotating when the BEV **101** is moving. Due to the smaller size of the fifth wheel **202**, as described above, the fifth wheel **202** rotates with more RPMs than the wheels **106** of the BEV **100**. While the fifth wheel **202** rotates, the sprockets **208a** and **208b** described above also rotate, causing the generators **302a** and **302b** to generate electrical energy. The continued reduction in diameters of components between the wheels **106** and the pulleys **304** of the generators **302** ensures that the generators **302** rotate at a sufficiently fast rate (RPMs) that they generate power to supply to the OBCS **210**, as described herein. The electrical energy is fed to the OBCS **210**, which charges the BEV **100** via the charging port of the BEV **100**, or directly to the motor **104**. The fifth wheel **202** is retracted in response to the second signal from the controller, and may or may not continue to rotate and generate electricity under its inertia.

(49) As described above, due to the mass and other properties of the fifth wheel **202** or the flywheel or similar components, the fifth wheel **202** or the fly wheel or similar components may continue to rotate or otherwise maintain some mechanical energy though the fifth wheel **202** is no longer in contact with the ground or road surface while the BEV **100** is moving. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202**, once it reaches the 700 RPMs described above, is able to maintain its rotation even though the fifth wheel **202** is no longer being “driven” by the ground or road surface when the BEV **100** is moving. As such, the generators **302a** and **302b** are able to continue to generate electrical energy for charging the battery **102** or feeding the motor **104** of the BEV **100** via the OBCS **210**. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** or the flywheel or similar components may continue to generate mechanical energy that is converted to electrical energy by the generators **302a** and **302b** until the fifth wheel **202** or flywheel or similar components are stopped using the brake or similar components, as described above, or until the fifth wheel **202** or flywheel or similar components stop rotating due to friction. In some embodiments, the fifth wheel **202** or flywheel may be replaced with a geared motor or similar component that is smaller in diameter than the wheels **106**.

(50) In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** includes a second controller that communicates with the controller of the BEV **100**. In some embodiments, the second controller is configured to monitor and/or control one or more of the fifth wheel **202**, the generators **302a** and **302b**, and/or the OBCS **210** to control generating a charge for the battery **102** or the motor **104**. In some embodiments, the second controller may be configured to engage the brake or otherwise control the fifth wheel **202** to slow the fifth wheel **202** in a controlled manner, for example based on whether or not the OBCS **210** can accept electricity from the generators **302a** and **302b**. In some embodiments, the second controller may prevent the battery **102** from being overcharged by the OBCS **210**. In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** may include controls, etc., to prevent overcharging of the battery **102**. In some embodiments, the second controller may be configured to disengage a safety or control that would prevent the BEV **100** from charging while moving or to control whether and when the OBCS **210** provides electricity directly to the motor **104** as opposed to the battery **102**.

(51) In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** includes a circuit breaker, fused connection, contactor, or similar electrically or mechanically switchable circuit element or component (not shown) designed to protect downstream components from the electrical output, for example, an excess current signal. In some embodiments, the circuit breaker is installed in series between the generators **302a** and **302b** and the battery charger **403** or in series between the battery charger **403** and the BEV charging port. In some embodiments, the circuit breaker is controlled by one or more of the controller of the BEV or the second controller of the OBCS **210** and disconnects downstream components from any upstream components. For example, if the battery **102** reaches a full state while being charged by the OBCS **210** or the motor **104** stops requesting energy, the BEV controller may send a signal to the circuit breaker to open the circuit/path between so that the battery **102** and/or the motor **104** is no longer receiving electricity from the OBCS **210**. In some

embodiments, the circuit breaker receives the “open” command or signal from the second controller of the OBCS **210**, which receives a signal that the battery **102** is in the fully charged state or the motor **104** no longer demands energy from the BEV controller. In some embodiments, the similar “stop charging” command may be provided to the OBCS **210** (from one or both of the BEV controller and the second controller of the OBCS **210**) and the OBCS **210** may stop providing a charge to the BEV based on receipt of such a command.

(52) In some embodiments, the battery **102** may have an input path by which the battery **102** is charged and an output path by which the battery **102** is discharged. In some embodiments, the input path may be similar (for example, in routing) to the output path. In some embodiments, the input and output paths may be different (for example, in routing). In some embodiments, the input path includes a single input node by which a charge is received to charge the battery **102**. For example, the single input node is coupled to the charging port of the BEV **100** and/or the regenerative braking system described above. In some embodiments, the input path includes a plurality of input nodes individually coupled to different charge sources. For example, a first input node is coupled to the charging port of the BEV **100** while a second input node is coupled to the regenerative braking port. As other charge sources are introduced, for example a capacitor array, another battery, a range extending generator, or another charge storage device, as described in further detail below, additional input nodes may be added to the battery **102** or the other charge sources may be coupled to the single input node along with the charging port and the regenerative braking system. Similarly, the output path may include a single output node or a plurality of output nodes by which the battery **102** are discharged to one or more loads, such as the electric motors **104** that move the BEV **100**, an DC/AC converter, or the other battery, capacitor, or charge storage device.

(53) FIG. 5 is a diagram of the exemplary BEV **500** of FIG. 1 incorporating one or more capacitor modules **502** as a supplemental and/or intermediate energy storage device. In some embodiments, the capacitor modules **502** are disposed alongside the battery **102**. The capacitor modules **502** and the battery **102** are electrically coupled to at least one deep cycle battery **504**. The capacitor modules **502** and the deep cycle battery **504** may be coupled to a DC-to-DC converter **506** that the battery **102** provides energy to the capacitor modules **502** and/or to the deep cycle battery **504** and vice versa.

(54) The battery **102** (for example, battery energy storage devices) as described herein generally store energy electrochemically. As such, a chemical reaction causes the release of energy (for example, electricity) that can be utilized in an electric circuit (for example, any of the circuits or motors described herein). In some embodiments, the battery **102** that is predominantly used in BEVs **500** is a lithium ion battery. Lithium ion batteries use lithium ion chemical reactions to discharge and charge the batteries. Due to the corresponding chemical processes associated with the charging and discharging, the charging and discharging of the battery **102** may be relatively time consuming. Additionally, the charging and discharging of the battery **102** may degrade the chemical components (for example, the lithium) within the battery **102**. However, the battery **102** is capable of storing large amounts of energy and, thus, have high energy densities.

(55) An alternative energy storage device is the capacitor (for example, supercapacitor and/or ultracapacitor) module **502** or energy storage device. The capacitor module **502** may store energy electrostatically instead of chemically. The capacitor module **502** may be charged and/or discharged more quickly than the battery **102**. The capacitor module **502** may be smaller in size than the corresponding battery **102** and, thus, may have a higher power density as compared to the corresponding battery **102**. However, while the capacitor module **502** may be charged and/or discharged more quickly than the corresponding battery **102**, the capacitor module **102** may have a lower energy density as compared to the battery **102**. As such, for the capacitor module **502** to have a corresponding energy density as compared to the corresponding battery **102**, the capacitor module **502** will have to be physically much larger than the corresponding battery **102**.

(56) In some embodiments, the capacitor modules **502** may be used in combination with the battery

102. For example, as shown in FIG. 5, the BEV **500** may include one or more the capacitor modules **502** installed alongside the battery **102**. In some embodiments, the BEV **500** includes a plurality of capacitor modules **502**. In some embodiments, one or more batteries **102** are replaced with one or more capacitor modules **502**. As shown, the capacitor modules **502** may be connected in series or in parallel with the battery **102**, dependent on the use case. For example, the capacitor modules **502** may be connected in series or parallel with the battery **102** when supplementing the voltage in the battery **102** or when charging the battery **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. Therefore, the battery **102** and the capacitor modules **502** may provide voltage support to each other. As such, the capacitor modules **502** may provide supplemental energy when the battery **102** are discharged or be used in place of the battery **102** altogether.

(57) In some embodiments, the capacitor modules **502** provide a burst of energy on demand to the battery **102** or to the motor **104**. For example, the capacitor modules **502** are coupled to the vehicle (or another) controller that monitors a charge level of the battery **102** and/or an energy demand of the motors **104**. The controller may control coupling of the capacitor modules **502** to the battery **102** to charge the battery **102** with the burst of energy from the capacitor modules **502** when the charge level of the battery **102** falls below a threshold value or may couple the capacitor modules **502** to the battery **102** to supplement an output energy of the battery **102**.

(58) The deep cycle battery **504** may be disposed at any location in the BEV **500** such that the deep cycle battery **504** is electrically coupled to the capacitor modules **502**, the battery **102**, and the generators **302a** and **302b**. The deep cycle battery **504** (or the battery **102** or the capacitor module **502**) may provide a sink or destination for excess energy generated by the generator **302a** and **302b**. For example, when the generators **302a** and/or **302b** generate energy and the capacitor modules **502** and the battery **102** are fully charged and/or otherwise unable to accept additional charge, the excess energy generated by the generators **302** and/or **302b** may be stored in the deep cycle battery **504**. This excess energy may then be fed back into the generators **302a** and **302b** or back into the battery **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. In some embodiments, when excess energy overflows to the deep cycle battery **504**, the deep cycle battery **504** provides backup power to the BEV **500** and/or provide power to any components of the BEV **500**, for example providing starting assistance if needed. As such, the deep cycle battery **504** may be coupled to the battery **102** and the capacitor modules **502** in a reconfigurable manner such that the deep cycle battery **504** may be used for storage of the overflow energy but also be connected to provide power to the battery **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. In some embodiments, the deep cycle battery **504** provides load balancing to the battery **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. In some embodiments, the capacitor modules **502** and/or the deep cycle battery **504** feeds power back to the generators **302a** and **302b** and/or directly into one of the battery **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. In some embodiments, the deep cycle battery **504** couples directly to a load of the BEV **500**. Thus, in some embodiments, one or more components of the BEV **500** (for example, one or more motors **104**, the drivetrain, auxiliary systems, heat, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) systems, and so forth) receives power from one or more of the battery **102**, the capacitor modules **502**, and the deep cycle battery **504**. In some embodiments, when the generators **302a** and/or **302b** generate energy and the battery **102** is fully charged and/or otherwise unable to accept additional charge and the motors **104** do not need any energy, the energy generated by the generators **302a** and **302b** may be excess energy. This excess energy may be stored in the capacitor module **502**. This excess energy may then be fed back into the generators **302a** and **302b** or back into the battery **102** and/or the motor **104**. In some embodiments, when excess energy overflows to the capacitor module **502**, the capacitor module **502** provides backup power to the BEV **500** and/or provides power to any components of the BEV **500**, for example providing starting assistance if needed.

(59) The DC-to-DC converter **506** may provide energy conversion between the generators **302** and one or more of the capacitor modules **502** and the deep cycle battery **504**. In some embodiments, the DC-to-DC converter **506** is integrated with the OBCS **210**. For example, the DC-to-DC

converter **506** is a component of the OBCS **210** that provides voltage conversion to charge the battery **102** and also charge the capacitor modules **502** and/or the deep cycle battery **504**. In some embodiments, the deep cycle battery **504** and the capacitor modules **502** are not coupled to the OBCS **210** and instead receive their energy directly from the generators **302**, for example via the DC-to-DC converter **506**. In some embodiments, the DC-to-DC converter **506** may comprise one or more components in the battery charger **403**.

(60) As shown in FIG. 5, the various components of the BEV **500** are integrated such that power generated by the fifth wheel **202** or a similar energy generation, regeneration, or recovery system (for example, regenerative braking, solar panels, and so forth) is stored in any of the battery **102**, the capacitor modules **502**, and the deep cycle battery **504**. In some embodiments, the deep cycle battery **504** and/or the capacitor modules **502** provide load balancing for the battery **102**, and vice versa. As such, the deep cycle battery **504** and/or the capacitor modules **502** may be coupled (in a switchable manner) to both the output of the generators **302** (via the DC-to-DC converter **506** and/or the OBCS **210**) and also the input of the generators **302**. Alternatively, the deep cycle battery **504** and/or the capacitor module **502** couples (in a switchable manner) to both the output of the battery **102** and also the input of the battery **102**. In some embodiments, the outputs of the deep cycle battery **504** and the capacitor modules **502** couple with the generators **302a** and **302b** to ensure that the battery **102** is charged with a sufficient voltage level.

(61) FIG. 6 is a diagram of the coupling of the fifth wheel **202** and the two generators **302a** and **302b** of FIG. 3 with the addition of a capacitor module **502** into the charging system of the BEV **100/500**. As shown, one or more of the capacitor modules **502** described above may be located and/or positioned as shown in FIG. 6. As described herein, the capacitor module **502** may be used to store energy for delivery to the battery **102** or the motor **104**.

(62) FIG. 7 is an alternate fifth wheel system **700** illustrating the fifth wheel of FIG. 2 mechanically coupled to a generation unit **710** that converts a mechanical rotation of the fifth wheel into an electrical energy output to the BEV **100**, for example the battery **102** or the capacitor module **502**. In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** described herein comprises the generation unit **710** (for example, instead of or in addition to the generators **302a** and **302b** described above). The generation unit **710** and the generators **302a** and **302b** may be used interchangeably herein. In some embodiments, the generation unit **710** may be directly coupled to the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and/or the motor **104**. The system **700** includes the fifth wheel **202** as supported by the support structure **200** as shown in FIG. 2. In some embodiments, the support structure **200** includes an independent suspension system **702** that enables the fifth wheel **202** and the corresponding components coupled to the fifth wheel **202** to move vertically and/or horizontally relative to the ground or the road surface or the BEV **100** to react or respond to variations in the road or road surface. The independent suspension **702** may operate independently of the suspension of the BEV **100**, thus allowing the fifth wheel **202** and corresponding components to move differently from the BEV **100**, allowing the fifth wheel system **700** to “float freely” relative to the BEV **100**. The independent suspension **702** may help protect the components coupled to the fifth wheel **202** (for example, the components shown in FIG. 7) by reducing the effects of the variations in the road or road surface to the components. In some embodiments, the independent suspension **702** includes one or more shocks, struts, linkages, springs, shock absorbers, or similar components that help enable, compensate for, and/or reduce the vertical and/or horizontal movement of the fifth wheel **202** and coupled components. In some embodiments, the independent suspension **702** also includes various components that improve stability of the components of the OBCS **210** described herein. For example, the independent suspension **702** may include a stabilization bracket **712** disposed between a flywheel **708** and a generation unit **710**, described in more detail below. The stabilization bracket **712** disposed between the flywheel **708** and the generation unit **710** may provide stabilizing supports between two components that move or have moving parts. The generation unit **710** may include the generator **302** described above or an alternator or any corresponding component(s) that

generate electricity from mechanical energy. The generation unit **710** may harvest the mechanical/kinetic energy from the movement of the BEV **100** (or from the inertia caused by the movement of the BEV **100**) prior to a build-up of friction or heat or other conditions that may otherwise cause energy to be lost by the BEV **100** (for example, to the heat or other conditions), thereby saving and storing energy that would otherwise be lost or wasted.

(63) The alternate system **700** further may include the fifth wheel **202** configured to rotate or spin on the shaft **206**. As described above, the rotation of the fifth wheel **202** causes the shaft **206** to rotate and further causes the sprocket **208** and chain **204** to rotate. The chain **204** is coupled to a second shaft **704**, for example via a second pulley or sprocket **709** rotated by the chain **204**. In some embodiments, the shaft **206** is coupled to the second shaft **704** via another means, for example a direct coupling, a geared coupling, and so forth. In some embodiments, the sprockets **208** and **709** (or similar components) and so forth may be sized to allow for balancing of rotational speeds between the various components. For example, the sprockets **208** on the shaft **206** and corresponding sprockets or gearing on the second shaft **704** are sized to balance rotations between the fifth wheel **202** and the generation unit **710**. In some embodiments, the sizing for the sprockets **208** and **709** (and similar components) is selected to control the electricity generated by the generation unit **710**.

(64) In some embodiments, the second shaft **704** includes a one-way bearing **706** (shown in FIG. **8A**) or similar component that allows a first portion of the second shaft **704** to rotate at least partially independently of a second portion of the second shaft **704**. The first portion of the second shaft **704** may be mechanically coupled to the shaft **206** (for example, via the chain **204**, the sprocket **709**, and the sprocket **208** or another mechanical coupling means). The second portion of the second shaft **704** may be mechanically coupled to the flywheel **708** or other mass and further coupled to the generation unit **710**. The flywheel **708**, as described above, may be configured to store kinetic energy generated by the rotation of the fifth wheel **202** and the second shaft **704**. The generation unit **710** may convert the mechanical kinetic energy of the flywheel **708** into electrical energy for storage in the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, or other energy storage device or conveyance to the motor **104** of FIG. **1**.

(65) The one-way bearing **706** may enable the first portion of the second shaft **704** to cause the second portion rotate while preventing the second portion from causing the first portion to rotate. Thus, the fifth wheel **202** may cause the flywheel **708** to rotate but the rotation of the flywheel **708** may have no impact on the rotation or movement of the fifth wheel **202**, the shaft **206**, and the sprocket **208**, and the chain **204**. Furthermore, due to the one-way bearing **706**, the flywheel **708** continues to rotate even if the fifth-wheel **202** slows or stops rotating. In some embodiments, the flywheel **708** includes a mass of approximately 25 kilograms (kg). This mass may vary based on the specifics of the BEV **100** and the generation unit **710**. For example, the flywheel **708** can have a mass of as little as 15 kg or as much as 75 kg, as described above. The mass of the flywheel **708** may allow the inertia of the rotating flywheel **708** to continue rotating when the fifth-wheel **202** slows or stops. The inertia may cause the flywheel **708** to rotate with sufficient speed and/or duration to cause the generation unit **710** to generate more than an unsubstantially amount of electrical energy. For example, the flywheel **708** mass of approximately 25 kg allows the flywheel **708** to continue rotating for a number of minutes after the fifth wheel **202** stops rotating. For example, if the fifth wheel **202** slows to a stop from a speed of rotating at approximately 60 miles per hour (mph) in thirty seconds, the inertia of the flywheel **708** may allow the flywheel **708** to continue to rotate for an additional five to ten minutes (for example, enabling the flywheel **708** to slow to a stop from the speed of 60 mph in the five or ten minutes). Thus, the inertia of the rotating flywheel **708** may enable the generation unit **710** to continue to generate electrical energy at a greater rate for a longer period of time than if the generation unit **710** is directly coupled to the fifth wheel **202**. In some embodiments, the mass of the flywheel **708** may be selected based on a desired time for the flywheel **708** to continue to rotate after the fifth wheel **202** stops rotating. For example,

if the flywheel **708** is to continue rotating for thirty minutes after the fifth wheel **202** stops rotating, then the flywheel **708** may be given a mass of 50 kg. In some embodiments, the one-way bearing **706**, the second shaft **704**, and the flywheel **708** are designed and assembled such that friction and/or other resistance to the rotation of these components is minimized or reduced to enable a maximum amount of kinetic energy from the rotation of the fifth wheel **202** to be converted into electrical energy by the generation unit **710**.

(66) Thus, the use of the one-way bearing **706** may enable the generation unit **710** to continue to generate electricity for the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and/or the motor **104** when the BEV **100** slows or comes to a physical stop (for example, when the BEV slows its momentum or stops moving). The one-way bearing **706** may include a first side that rotates or spins independently of a second side. The first and second sides may be coaxial. The flywheel **708** may be connected on the first side of the one-way bearing **706** and the first portion of the second shaft **704** may be connected on the second side of the one-way bearing **706**. Thus, the generation unit **710** may continue to generate electrical energy at a high rate even as the BEV **100** slows or is stopped. In some embodiments, the second shaft **704** includes multiple one-way bearings **706** that allow the second shaft **704** to support multiple flywheels **708** that can independently drive one or more generation units **710**, thereby allowing the inertia of the flywheels **708** to generate larger amounts of electrical energy (not shown these figures).

(67) In some embodiments, instead of or in addition to the second shaft **704** including the first portion and the second portion, the one-way bearing **706** couples directly to the flywheel **708** which is coupled directly to the generation unit **710**. Thus, the second shaft **704** may include a single portion where the one-way bearing **706** allows the directly coupled flywheel **708** to continue rotating even when the fifth wheel **202** slows or is not rotating. As the flywheel **708** is directly coupled to the generation unit **710**, the generation unit **710** is also able to continue generating the electrical energy based on the rotation of the flywheel **708** when the fifth wheel **202** slows or stops rotating. Further details of how the flywheel **708** and the generation unit **710** are coupled are provided below.

(68) The generation unit **710** may be electrically coupled to a capacitor (for example, one of the capacitor modules **502**), the battery **102**, the motor **104**, and/or a cut-off switch. The cut-off switch may disconnect the output of the generation unit **710** from the capacitor, the battery **102**, and/or the motor **104** such that electrical energy generated by the generation unit **710** may be transferred to the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, or to the motors **104** as needed. In some embodiments, the cut-off switch can be controlled by an operator or the controller of the BEV **100** or the second controller of the OBCS **210**. For example, the controller of the BEV **100** or the OBCS **210** may receive, identify, and/or determine an interrupt signal to initiate the dump. In response to the interrupt signal, the controller may disconnect the output of the generation unit **710** from the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and/or the motor **104**. Disconnecting the output of the generation unit **710** from the capacitor, the battery **102**, and/or the motor **104** may ensure that any residual electrical energy in one or more components of the OBCS **210** (for example, the generation unit **710**) is transferred or “dumped” to the battery **102** and/or the capacitor module **502** and therefore control a supply of back-up high voltage. In some embodiments, during the dump, the output of the generation unit **710** may be connected to a dump load or similar destination when disconnected from the capacitor module **502**, the battery **102**, and/or the motor **104** to prevent damage to any coupled electrical components. In some embodiments, the dump load may comprise a back-up battery, capacitor, or similar energy storage device. In some embodiments, the voltage dump may occur for a period of time and/or at periodic intervals defined by one or more of a time for example since a previous dump, a distance traveled by the vehicle for example since the previous dump, a speed of the vehicle for example since the previous dump, and a power generated and/or output by the generation unit **710**, for example since the previous dump. After the dump is complete (for example, the period of time expires), then the controller may disconnect the dump

load from the generation unit output (for example, at a generation unit terminal) and reconnect the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and the motor **104**.

(69) In some embodiments, the voltage dump may comprise opening a contactor that is positioned downstream of the generation unit **710** or the generators **302**. Opening the contactor may disconnect the generation unit **710** or the generators **302** from the downstream components (for example, the load components for the generation unit **710** or the generators **302**). In some embodiments, the controls for initiating and/or deactivating the dump are conveniently located for the vehicle operator to access or coupled to the controller for the BEV **100**.

(70) In some embodiments, the generation unit **710** outputs the generated electrical energy in pulses or with a constant signal. For example, the operator or the controller of the BEV **100** or the second controller of the OBCS **210** In some embodiments, the generation unit **710** is switchable between outputting the electrical energy in pulses or in the constant signal. The operator may control whether the output is pulsed or constant or the OBCS **210** may automatically control whether the output is pulsed or constant without operator intervention based on current demands of the BEV **100** and so forth. In some embodiments, when the output is pulsed, the operator and/or the OBCS **210** can control aspects of the pulsed signal, including a frequency of the pulse, an amplitude of the pulse, a duration of each pulse, and so forth. Similarly, when the output is constant, the operator and/or the OBCS **210** may control aspects of the constant signal, including a duration of the signal and an amplitude of the signal.

(71) In some embodiments, the operator of the BEV **100** can control the height of the fifth wheel **202**. For example, the operator determines when to lower the fifth wheel **202** so that it is in contact with the road or a road surface, thereby causing the fifth wheel **202** to rotate. The operator may have controls for whether the fifth wheel **202** is in a raised position, where it is not in contact with the road, or in a lowered position, where it is in contact with the road. Additionally, or alternatively, the operator may have options to control specifics of the raised or lowered position, for example how low to position the fifth wheel **202**. Such controls may allow the operator to control the amount of force that the fifth wheel **202** provides on the road or road surface, which may impact the electrical energy generated by the OBCS **210**. For example, when the fifth wheel **202** is pressing down on the road surface with a large amount of force, then this force may create more resistance against the fifth wheel **202** rotating when the BEV **100** is moving, thereby reducing the electrical energy generated by the OBCS **210**. On the other hand, when the force on the fifth wheel **202** is small amount of force, then the fifth wheel **202** may lose contact with the road or road surface depending on variations in the road surface, thereby also reducing the electrical energy generated by the OBCS **210**. Thus, the controls may provide the operator with the ability to tailor the downward force exerted by the fifth wheel **202** on the road based on road conditions and based on the need for power. In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** may automatically control the force of the fifth wheel **202** on the road to maximize electrical energy generation based on monitoring of the road surface and electrical energy being generated.

(72) Additionally, the operator of the BEV **100** may choose to extend the fifth wheel **202** so that it contacts the road or retract the fifth wheel **202** so that it does not contact the road based on draft or drag conditions. For example, if the drag increases or is expected to increase based on various conditions, the operator may choose to retract the fifth wheel **202** or keep the fifth wheel **202** retracted. If the drag decreases or is expected to decrease based on conditions, then the operator may choose to extend the fifth wheel **202** or keep it extended. In some embodiments, the OBCS **210** may automatically extend and/or retract the fifth wheel **202** based on drag or potential drag conditions without the operator's involvement.

(73) FIGS. **8A** and **8B** provide additional views of the alternate fifth wheel system **700** of FIG. **7**. The additional views show details regarding the stabilization bracket **712** disposed between the flywheel **708** and the generation unit **710**. In some embodiments, the stabilization bracket **712** bolts to the support structure **200** described herein. As the support structure **200** includes the independent

suspension **702**, the stabilization bracket **712** may be protected from sudden movements of the fifth wheel **202**. The stabilization bracket **712** may provide support for one or both of the flywheel **708** and the generation unit **710**. For example, a drive shaft or similar component may pass from the flywheel **708** to the generation unit **710** through the stabilization bracket **712**. For example, the generation unit **710** includes an axle or input shaft that, when rotated, causes the generation unit **710** to generate an electrical energy output relative to the rotation of the input shaft. The input shaft of the generation unit **710** may pass into and through the stabilization bracket, as shown in further detail with respect to FIG. **9**. The flywheel **708** may be directly disposed on the input shaft of the generation unit **710** or may otherwise couple to the input shaft of the generation unit **710** such that rotation of the flywheel **708** causes the input shaft to rotate. Due to the one-way bearing **706**, the flywheel **708** continues to rotate even if the fifth-wheel **202** slows or stops rotating.

(74) For example, a weight of the flywheel **708** may produce a downward force on the second shaft **704** and the one-way bearing **706**. The stabilization bracket **712** may provide dual purposes of relieving some of the force on the one-way bearing **706** and the second shaft **704**, thereby extending the operating lives of one or both of the one-way bearing **706** and the second shaft **704** as well as reducing vibrations, etc., of the generation unit **710**, the flywheel **708**, the one-way bearing **706**, and the second shaft **704**. The stabilization bracket **712** may keep these components from shaking during rotation, thereby providing improve stability of the support structure **200** as a whole. In some embodiments, the stabilization bracket **712** includes a hole through which the input shaft of the generation unit **710** passes. The hole may include a bearing or similar component that supports the input shaft passing through the hole while also reducing or minimizing drag or friction on the input shaft.

(75) In some embodiments, as shown in FIG. **9**, which provides a close-up view of the stabilization bracket **712** between the generation unit **710** and the flywheel **708**, the generation unit **712** may be bolted to the stabilization bracket **712**.

(76) FIGS. **10A-10P** are screenshots of an interface that presents various data points that are monitored during operation of the EV with an example embodiment of the generators **302**, the generation unit **710**, and/or the OBCS **210** described herein. Each of the screenshots of FIGS. **10A-10P** include a torque field **1005** indicating a torque value generated by the fifth wheel or similar drive component (e.g., the small motor) for the OBCS **210**, measured in Newton-meters (Nm). Each of the screenshots of FIGS. **10A-10P** also include three phase currents for the three-phase AC power generated by the generators **302** or the generation unit **710**. For example, a first phase current field **1010** indicates a current value of a first phase of the three-phase AC power generated by the generators **302** or generation unit **710** (and fed to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, or motor **104** via the battery charger **403** or similar filtering, conversion, and conditioning circuits). A second phase current **1015** field indicates a current value of a second phase of the three-phase AC power generated by the generators **302** or generation unit **710**. A third phase current field **1020** indicates a current value of a third phase of the three-phase AC power generated by the generators **302** or generation unit **710**. Each current value of the first phase current field **1010**, the second phase current field **1015**, and the third phase current field **1020** is measured in amps (A).

(77) Each of the screenshots of FIGS. **10A-10P** also include a speed field **1025** that indicates a rotational speed value of the rotor of the motor (or generator **302** or generation unit **710**) of the OBCS **210**, measured in rotations per minute (RPM). Each of the screenshots of FIGS. **10A-10P** also include a current field **1030** that indicates a current value of a current being generated by the OBCS **210** while the motor of the OBCS **210** is rotating, the current measured in amps (A). Each of the screenshots of FIGS. **10A-10P** also include a temperature field **1035** that indicates a temperature of the OBCS **210**, in Celsius (C). Each of the screenshots of FIGS. **10A-10P** also include a voltage field **1040** that indicates a voltage value for a voltage generated by the OBCS **210** after passing through rectification, conversion, conditioning, and so forth, measured in direct current volts (V DC). In some embodiments, the voltage field indicates voltage measure of the

battery **102** or other power source that feeds the motor **104** to drive the BEV **100**.

(78) The screenshots **10A-10P** described in further detail below depict electrical generation conditions of the BEV **100** while the BEV **100** is traveling. For example, for the screenshots of FIGS. **10A-10P**, the BEV **100** is traveling (a) at a speed of between 48 MPH and 53 MPH along a substantially flat road surface for a majority of distance traveled and (b) up an incline for approximately 13 miles. The screenshots **10A-10P** show how the phase currents (**1010-1020**) for the AC signal generated by the motor vary at different times but sum to substantially zero at any given moment of time (for example, indicating that the motor is feeding a balanced load). The motor speed **1025** shown in the screenshots may be indicative of the current **1030** except when the voltage dump is being completed.

(79) FIG. **10A** shows a screenshot **1001a** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005a** of approximately -57.4 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010a** is -5.31 A, the second phase current value in **1015a** is -143.06 A, and the third phase current value in **1020a** is 148.94 A. The speed value in **1025a** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5008 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030a** of 70 A at the temperature value in **1035a** of 51.05 C. The voltage value in **1040a** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5008 RPM is 377.2 V.

(80) The screenshot **1001a** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 70 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040a** of 377.2 V. The 70 A current **1030a** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 377.2 V.

(81) FIG. **10B** shows a screenshot **1001b** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005b** of approximately -57.4 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010b** is -137.19 A, the second phase current value in **1015b** is 152.25 A, and the third phase current value in **1020b** is -14.94 A. The speed value in **1025b** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5025 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030b** of -70 A at the temperature value in **1035b** of 51.14 C. The voltage value in **1040b** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5025 RPM is 379.17 V.

(82) The screenshot **1001b** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 70 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040b** of 379.17 V. The 70 A current **1030b** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 379.17 V.

(83) FIG. **10C** shows a screenshot **1001c** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005c** of approximately -57.4 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010b** is 80.5 A, the second phase current value in **1015c** is -160.06 A, and the third phase current value in **1020c** is 80.12 A. The speed value in **1025c** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5011 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030c**

of -69.6 A at the temperature **1035c** of 51.22 C. The voltage value in **1040c** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5011 RPM is 380.17 V.

(84) The screenshot **1001c** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69.6 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040c** of 380.17 V. The 69.6 A current **1030c** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 380.17 V.

(85) FIG. **10D** shows a screenshot **1001d** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005d** of approximately -57.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010d** is 170.69 A, the second phase current value in **1015d** is -131.94 A, and the third phase current value in **1020d** is -38.19 A. The speed value in **1025d** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 4969 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030d** of -69 A at the temperature value in **1035d** of 51.31 C. The voltage value in **1040d** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4969 RPM is 380.92 V.

(86) The screenshot **1001d** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040d** of 380.92 V. The 69 A current **1030d** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 380.92 V.

(87) FIG. **10E** shows a screenshot **1001e** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005e** of approximately -56.8 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010e** is -133.31 A, the second phase current value in **1015e** is -40.75 A, and the third phase current value in **1020e** is 174.19 A. The speed value in **1025e** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5121 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030e** of -69.6 A at the temperature value in **1035e** of 52.77 C. The voltage value in **1040e** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4969 RPM is 382.67 V.

(88) The screenshot **1001e** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69.6 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040e** of 382.67 V. The 69.6 A current **1030e** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 382.67 V.

(89) FIG. **10F** shows a screenshot **1001f** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005f** of approximately -57 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010f** is 8.75 A, the second phase current value in **1015f** is 145.44 A, and the third phase current value in **1020f** is -153.62 A. The speed value in **1025f** of the generator or motor

of the OBCS **210** is 5062 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030f** of -69.4 A at the temperature value in **1035f** of 52.86 C. The voltage value in **1040f** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5062 RPM is 383.21 V.

(90) The screenshot **1001f** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69.4 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040f** of 383.21 V. The 69.4 A current **1030f** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 383.21 V.

(91) FIG. **10G** shows a screenshot **1001g** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005g** of approximately -57.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010g** is -161.94 A, the second phase current value in **1015g** is 29.56 A, and the third phase current value in **1020g** is 132 A. The speed value in **1025g** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 4937 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030g** of -68.8 A at the temperature value in **1035g** of 53.03 C. The voltage value in **1040g** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4937 RPM is 381.92 V.

(92) The screenshot **1001g** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 68.8 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040g** of 381.92 V. The 68.8 A current **1030g** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 681.91 V.

(93) FIG. **10H** shows a screenshot **1001h** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005h** of approximately -57.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010h** is -89.69 A, the second phase current value in **1015h** is 161.44 A, and the third phase current value in **1020h** is -70.69 A. The speed value in **1025h** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 4890 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030h** of -69.2 A at the temperature value in **1035h** of 53.55 C. The voltage value in **1040h** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4890 RPM is 377.42 V.

(94) The screenshot **1001h** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69.2 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040h** of 377.42 V. The 69.2 A current **1030h** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 377.42 V.

(95) FIG. **10I** shows a screenshot **1001i** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005i** of approximately -57.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010i** is 90.69 A, the second phase current value in **1015i** is 80 A, and the

third phase current value in **1020i** is -169.12 A. The speed **1025i** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 4971 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030i** of -69.8 A at the temperature value in **1035i** of 53.8 C. The voltage value in **1040i** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4971 RPM is 378.2 V.

(96) The screenshot **1001i** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69.8 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040b** of 378.2 V. The 69.8 A current **1030i** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 378.2 V.

(97) FIG. **10J** shows a screenshot **1001j** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005j** of approximately -57.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010j** is 149.38 A, the second phase current value in **1015j** is -145.5 A, and the third phase current value in **1020j** is -1.88 A. The speed value in **1025j** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 4987 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030h** of -70 A at the temperature value in **1035j** of 53.89 C. The voltage value in **1040j** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4987 RPM is 377.1 V.

(98) The screenshot **1001j** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 70 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040b** of 377.1 V. The 70 A current **1030i** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 377.1 V.

(99) FIG. **10K** shows a screenshot **1001k** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005k** of approximately -567.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010k** is -174.06 A, the second phase current value in **1015k** is 111 A, and the third phase current value in **1020k** is 63.12 A. The speed value in **1025k** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 4996 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030k** of -69.6 A at the temperature value in **1035k** of 54.06 C. The voltage value in **1040k** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4996 RPM is 378.51 V.

(100) The screenshot **1001k** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69.6 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040b** of 378.51 V. The 69.6 A current **1030k** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 378.51 V.

(101) FIG. **10L** shows a screenshot **1001l** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005l** of approximately -57.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first

phase current value in **1010l** is 62.12 A, the second phase current value in **1015l** is -169.25 A, and the third phase current value in **1020l** is 108.25 A. The speed value in **1025l** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 4954 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030l** of -69.6 A at the temperature value in **1035l** of 54.41 C. The voltage value in **1040l** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 4954 RPM is 378.86 V.

(102) The screenshot **1001l** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 69.6 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040b** of 378.86 V. The 69.6 A current **1030l** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 378.86 V.

(103) FIG. **10M** shows a screenshot **1001m** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005m** of approximately -9.2 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010m** is 113.06 A, the second phase current value in **1015m** is -147 A, and the third phase current value in **1020m** is 34.5 A. The speed value in **1025m** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5587 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030m** of -0.2 A at the temperature value in **1035m** of 55.27 C. The voltage value in **1040m** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5587 RPM is 377.32 V.

(104) The screenshot **1001m** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 0.2 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040m** of 377.32 V. The 0.2 A current **1030m** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 377.32 V.

(105) FIG. **10N** shows a screenshot **1001n** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005n** of approximately -9.2 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010n** is 84.94 A, the second phase current value in **1015n** is -74.75 A, and the third phase current value in **1020n** is -9.62 A. The speed value in **1025n** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5600 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030n** of -28.4 A at the temperature value in **1035n** of 55.69 C. The voltage value in **1040n** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5600 RPM is 378.07 V.

(106) The screenshot **1001n** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 28.4 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040n** of 378.07 V. The 28.4 A current **1030n** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 378.07 V.

(107) FIG. **10O** shows a screenshot **1001o** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005o** of approximately -56.6 Nm (the negative value representing

a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010o** is -74.19 A, the second phase current value in **1015o** is -88.31 A, and the third phase current value in **1020o** is 163 A. The speed value in **1025o** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5153 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030o** of -70.8 A at the temperature value in **1035o** of 56.5 C. The voltage value in **1040o** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5153 RPM is 376.88 V.

(108) The screenshot **10010** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 70.8 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040o** of 376.88 V. The 70.8 A current **1030o** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 376.88 V.

(109) FIG. **10P** shows a screenshot **1001p** for when the fifth wheel **202** is in contact with the road and providing a torque value in **1005p** of approximately -56.6 Nm (the negative value representing a torque opposing the direction of the motion of the EV). The screenshot also shows that the first phase current value in **1010p** is 37.38 A, the second phase current value in **1015p** is -164.44 A, and the third phase current value in **1020o** is 128.12 A. The speed value in **1025p** of the generator or motor of the OBCS **210** is 5137 RPM and the OBCS **210** is generating the current value in **1030p** of -70.8 A at the temperature value in **1035p** of 56.59 C. The voltage value in **1040p** generated by the OBCS **210** at the speed of 5137 RPM is 378.29 V.

(110) The screenshot **1001p** may show an instance when the OBCS **210** is generating electricity and providing the electricity to the battery **102**, capacitor module **502**, and/or the motors **104** of the EV. In some embodiments, the electricity may be provided to the motors **104** through the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502** or via a separate connection that bypasses the battery modules **102** and/or the capacitor modules **502**. The OBCS **210** may generate the 70.8 A of current used to maintain the voltage of the EV's battery **102** and/or capacitor module **502** at or around the voltage **1040b** of 378.29 V. The 70.8 A current **1030p** is provided to the motor **104**, the battery module **102**, and/or the capacitor module **502** to maintain the voltage at approximately 378.29 V.

(111) In some embodiments, voltages flow between the generator, the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and/or the motor **104**. For example, the electricity generated by the generators **302a** and **302** or the generation unit **710** may be output from the generator **302** or generation unit **710** and fed into components for converting conditioning, rectifying, matching, filtering, and/or otherwise modifying the generated electricity. Once the electricity is modified as described herein, the electricity may be conveyed to an energy storage device, such as the battery **102** and/or the capacitor module **502**. The energy stored in the battery **102** or the capacitor module **502** may be used to feed one or more DC loads, for example low voltage DC loads, such as the 12V DC battery and internal features and components of the BEV **100**. Alternatively, the energy stored in the battery **102** or the capacitor module **502** may be used to feed the motors **104** or other high voltage demand components. In some embodiments, the motors **104** may be AC or DC motors; when AC motors, the high voltage output from the battery **102** or the capacitor module **502** may be converted from DC to AC before feeding into the motors **104**. When the motors **104** are DC motors, further conditioning may not be required before the voltage is fed to the motors **104**. Alternatively, the high voltage output from the battery **102** and/or the capacitor module **502** may be used to feed into the generation unit **710** or generators **302** to jump start the generation unit **710** or generators **302** when they are being used to convert mechanical energy to electricity for storage or use in driving the motor **104**. In some embodiments, when the battery **102** and the capacitor module **502** both exist in

the BEV **100** as separate components, the battery **102** may feed energy to the capacitor module **502** and/or vice versa.

(112) In some embodiments, the generators **302** and/or generation unit **710** described herein couple directly to one or more of the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and the motor **104**.

Alternatively, or additionally, the generators **302** and/or generation unit are coupled to the battery charger **403**, which is coupled to the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and/or the motor **104**. In some embodiments, when the generators **302** and/or generation unit **710** are not coupled to the battery charger **403**, the generators **302** and/or generation unit **710** may instead be coupled to one or more circuits to rectify and/or otherwise match, convert, and/or condition the electricity generated by the generators **302** and/or generation unit before feeding the battery **102**, the capacitor module **502**, and/or the motor **104**.

(113) FIGS. **11A-11B** depict different views of an example embodiment of components of a bearing support **1100**. The bearing support **1100** can be configured to support, facilitate, or enable a rotating element, such as a rotating shaft. Further, and as will be described in more detail below, the bearing support **1100** can be advantageously configured to dissipate heat generated by rotation of the rotating element. Heat may be generated, for example, by friction between components as the rotating element rotates. If such generated heat is not sufficiently dissipated, the components may deteriorate or otherwise become damaged. For example, in some cases, if heat is not sufficiently dissipated, components may melt, degrading the function thereof.

(114) In some embodiments, the bearing support **1100** may be used anywhere that any rotating element is physically supported or coupled to another component (e.g., another rotating or stationary component). For example, the bearing support **1100** can be used to support end, center, and/or other portions of the shaft **206** of FIG. **2** or the second shaft **704** of FIG. **7**. The bearing support **1100** can support the portions of the shafts and other rotating components on the BEV **100** or the support structure **200** or couple the portions to other rotating or stationary components in the BEV **100** or the OBCS **210**. In some embodiments, the one-way bearing **706** discussed above comprises the bearing support **1100**. In some embodiments, the bearing support **1100** may provide support for rotating axles and components, reduction of diameters of rotating components, and so forth. The bearing support **1100** may be used in various contexts in any embodiment of the OBCS **201** described herein, with reference to FIGS. **2-9**. In some embodiments, the bearing support **1100** may be used in various other applications, from automotive, industrial, consumer, appliance, and home use applications.

(115) FIG. **11A** is a top down view of the bearing support **1100**, illustrated in a partially disassembled state. FIG. **11B** is another perspective view of the bearing support in a partially disassembled state. In the illustrated embodiment, the bearing support **1100** comprises a bearing housing or enclosure **1105** and a bearing assembly **1110**. While FIGS. **11A** and **11B**, illustrate the bearing support **1100** in a partially disassembled state, when assembled, at least a portion of the bearing assembly **1110** can be positioned within the bearing enclosure **1105**.

(116) As shown in FIG. **11A**, the bearing assembly **1110** comprises a shaft **1215** and one or more bearings **1205** (e.g., first and second bearing **1205a**, **1205b**) configured to facilitate rotation of the shaft **1215**. The one or more bearings **1205** can be mounted on the shaft **1215** as shown. The one or more bearings **1205** can comprise mechanical devices configured to enable rotational movement of the shaft **1215**. The one or more bearings **1205** can comprise rotary bearings that convey or transfer one or more of axial and radial motions and forces between components or devices. In some embodiments, the one or more bearings **1205** may comprise one or more of a ring bearing, a rolling-element bearing, a jewel bearing, a fluid bearing, a magnetic bearing, and a flexure bearing, among other suitable bearing types.

(117) As used herein, the one or more bearings **1205** may be enable rotational rotation. In some embodiments, additional bearings **1205** or only one of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** may be used in any application. As best shown in FIG. **11B**, the one or more bearings **1205** may comprise an

inner ring **1223** and an outer ring **1225**. The one or more bearings **1205** can also include one or more rolling elements (not visible) positioned between the inner ring **1223** and the outer ring **1225**. The one or more rolling elements can facilitate rotation of the inner ring **1223** relative the outer ring **1225**. The one or more rolling elements can be positioned within a cage **1227**. The inner ring **1223** may be fitted on the shaft **1215**. For example, the inner ring **1223** can have an inner diameter through which a shaft or other mechanical component passes (for example, the shaft **1215**). The outer ring **1225** may have an outer diameter over which an enclosure or other mechanical component passes (for example, the bearing enclosure **1105**). The rolling elements and the cage **1227** may be disposed between the inner ring and the outer ring (moving within one or raceways formed in the inner ring and/or the outer ring) to enable rotation movement of the inner ring relative to the outer ring, or vice versa. In some embodiments, different particularities for the bearing support **1100** may depend on the application in which the bearing support **1100** is used. The gaps between the bearing spacer **1110** and each of the bearings **1105a** and **1105b** is not clearly shown in the perspective view of FIG. **11B**.

(118) Often, as the shaft **1215** rotates, friction between the rolling elements and the inner and outer rings **1223**, **1227** (or other components of the device) generates heat. As noted above, if such heat is not dissipated, it can cause damage to the components, which may reduce or destroy their ability to facilitate rotation of the shaft **1215**. Accordingly, the bearing support **1100** can be configured to facilitate heat dissipation as will be described in more detail below.

(119) As shown in FIGS. **11A** and **11B**, the bearing enclosure **1105** of the bearing support **1100** can comprise a housing or enclosure that is configured to receive at least a portion of the bearing assembly **1110**. In the illustrated embodiment, the bearing enclosure **1105** comprises an exterior surface **1106** having a substantially cylindrical shape and an interior surface **1107** having a cylindrical shape. Other shapes of the exterior and interior surfaces **1106**, **1107** are also possible. In some embodiments, the shape of the exterior surface **1106** of the bearing enclosure **1105** is dependent on an application and/or installation location of the bearing enclosure **1105**. For example, the exterior surface **1106** of the bearing enclosure **1105** can be configured to facilitate connection of the bearing support **1100** to other components.

(120) An interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105** may be hollow and at least partially defined by the interior surface **1107**. As noted above, in the illustrated embodiment, the interior surface **1107** comprises a cylindrical shape such that the hollow interior portion **1108** is substantially cylindrical. Such a shape can be configured to correspond with the generally circular or cylindrical shape of the one or more bearings **1205** of the bearing assembly **1105** such that the bearing assembly **1105** can be received within the interior portion **1108**.

(121) In some embodiments, the shape of the interior surface **1107** of the bearing enclosure **1105** is dependent on a shape of a bearing or similar device (for example, bearing **1205**, described herein) that is inserted into the interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105**. The interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105** may receive the bearing assembly **1110** such that the bearing assembly **1110** fits, at least in part, within the interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105**. For example, the bearing assembly **1110** may be inserted, at least in part, into the interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105** in a horizontal direction (e.g., a direction parallel to an axis of the shaft **1215** or parallel to the axis of rotation of the bearings **1205**), such that only a portion of the bearing assembly **1110** extends out of the bearing enclosure **1105**. For example, the shaft **1215** can extend out from the bearing enclosure **1105**. When the interior surface **1107** is cylindrical to accept the round or cylindrical bearing **1205** (for example, the pair of bearings **1205a** and **1205b** included in the bearing assembly **1110**), the cylindrical interior portion **1108** may have a diameter substantially the same as (but slightly larger than) an outer diameter of the bearing **1205**. Thus, the interior surface **1107** of the bearing enclosure **1105** is configured to hold the bearing **1205** or any bearing assembly **1110** pressed into the interior portion **1108** in place using friction and compressive forces once the bearing **1205** or bearing assembly **1110** is pressed into the bearing enclosure **1105**.

(122) In the assembled state, the inner rings **1223** of the bearings **1205** can spin or rotate within the outer rings **1225** of the bearing **1205** while the outer rings **1225** remain stationary within the bearing enclosure **1105**, such that the shaft **1215** that is coupled to the inner rings **1223** of the bearings **1205** can rotate or move relative to the bearing enclosure **1105**. As noted previously, such rotation and movement can create heat within the bearings **1205**, a build-up of which can cause the bearing **1205** to fail prematurely or otherwise damage one or more of the bearings **1205**, the bearing enclosure **1105**, and the shaft **1215** within the bearings **1205**.

(123) Accordingly, the bearing support **1100** can be configured to facilitate improved airflow within the bearing enclosure **1105** which may reduce the heat build-up within the bearing enclosure **1105** around the bearings **1205**. Introducing ports or paths for airflow into the bearing enclosure **1105** can improve airflow therethrough. For example, the bearing enclosure **1105** may include one or more slots, holes, perforations, or other openings that extend from the exterior surface **1106** to the interior surface **1107** through a side of the bearing enclosure **1105**. The one or more slots, holes, perforations, or other openings allow air to better flow from outside the bearing enclosure **1105** to the interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105**.

(124) Additionally, the interior surface **1107** may comprise one or more indentations, dimples, fingers, channels, or tabs (each hereinafter referred to as indentations) at a location to which the bearings **1205** are coupled. The one or more indentations may create individual points or portions at which the interior surface **1107** contacts the bearing **1205** such that the interior surface **1107** is not in contact with an entire exterior surface of the bearing **1205**. The one or more indentations may allow air to flow around the bearings **1205** (for example, from a first side of the bearing **1205** to a second side of the bearing **1205**) within the bearing enclosure **1105**. Such air flow may further reduce heat build-up around the bearing **1205** when the bearing **1205** is enabling rotation or movement in the bearing enclosure **1105**. In some embodiments, the one or more indentations may be of varying depths, shapes, lengths, and heights. For example, the one or more indentations in the interior surface **1107** of the bearing enclosure **1105** may have a depth in the thousandths of an inch (for example, approximately 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009", 0.01" " , 0.02, 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween). In some embodiments, the one or more indentations may have any shape or height (for example, approximately 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009", 0.01", 0.02", 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween). The one or more indentations may also have a width sufficient to ensure that air flows from the first side to the second side of the bearing **1205** (for example a width that is slightly larger than a width or thickness of the bearing **1205**). In some embodiments, the width of the one or more indentations is slightly larger than the width of the bearing **1205**. For example, the width of the one or more indentations may be long enough such that the indentation extends on either side of the bearing **1205** by a distance of one of approximately or at least 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009", 0.01", 0.02", 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween. While described primarily as indentations, protrusions, which extend outwardly from the interior surface **1107** of the bearing enclosure **1105** may also be used. For example, the protrusions can extend to and contact the bearings **1205**, while also allowing air to flow around the protrusions to facilitate cooling of the bearings **1205**. In cases where protrusions are utilized, the protrusions may have a height equal to the various depths of the indentations described above.

(125) The one or more indentations (or protrusions) may reduce an amount of surface contact between the bearing **1205** (for example, the outer ring **1225**) and the interior surface **1107** of the bearing enclosure **1105**. In order to prevent the bearing **1205** from moving laterally within the bearing enclosure **1105**, a tab, wedge, key, or similar device (hereinafter referred to as tab) may be inserted into one of the one or more indentations or otherwise pressed against the bearing **1205** and the interior surface **1107** of the bearing enclosure **1105** to ensure that the bearing **1205** does not move laterally within the bearing enclosure **1105**. Thus, the introduction of any of the indentations or holes described herein may improve air flow within the bearing enclosure **1105**, reducing

bearing failures and improving bearing functionality and life, without increasing risk of movement of the bearing **1205**.

(126) As shown in FIG. **11A**, for example, the bearing assembly **1110** may comprise one or more bearings (e.g. the first and second bearings **1205a** and **1205b**) mounted on the shaft **1215** and, additionally, a bearing spacer **1210** and a clamp **1220**. These components of the bearing assembly **1110** may be arranged such that the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** are separated from each other by the bearing spacer **1210**. The arrangement of the bearing **1205a**, the bearing spacer **1210**, and the bearing **1205b** may be positioned at an end of the shaft **1215** and the clamp **1220** may hold the arrangement on or at the end of the shaft **1215**. In some embodiments, the bearing spacer **1210** is separated from each of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** on one or more sides of the bearing spacer **1210** by a predetermined length gap. The predetermined length gap may be one of 1 millimeter (mm), 2 mm, 3 mm, 4 mm, 5 mm, 6 mm, 7 mm, 8 mm, 9 mm, or 10 mm in length, and so forth, or any value therebetween. In some embodiments, the predetermined length gap is determined during manufacturing of the bearing assembly **1110** and the bearing support **1100**. In some embodiments, the predetermined length gap may be selected or determined based on one or more of an expected load on the bearing assembly (for example, the expected rotational speed, expected working temperatures, expected duration of use, and so forth). The gaps created by the bearing spacer **1210** may further facilitate cooling and heat dissipation by creating spaces for air to flow around the one or more bearings **1205**.

(127) The clamp **1220** may be separated from the arrangement of the bearing **1205a**, the bearing spacer **1210**, and the bearing **1205b** or may be positioned flush with the arrangement (for example, flush with the bearing **1205b**). The clamp **1220** may include a mechanical device (for example, a locking screw or similar component) to mechanically prevent the clamp **1220** from moving one or more of rotationally around the shaft **1215** or laterally along the shaft **1215**. Thus, the clamp **1220** may prevent other components from moving along or around the shaft **1215** or limit movement of the other components along or around the shaft **1215**. The clamp **1220** may have an outer diameter that is large enough to prevent the bearings **1205** and/or the bearing spacer **1210** from moving over the clamp **1220** but smaller than the diameter of the interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105**.

(128) In some embodiments, the shaft **1215** comprises a plurality of sections, including an end section **1216** and a middle section **1217**. The end section **1216** comprises the section of the shaft **1215** where the bearing assembly **1110** is installed and can include a larger diameter than middle section **1217**, although this need not be the case in all embodiments. For example, the shaft **1215** can, in some embodiments, comprise a shape having a constant diameter along its length. As shown in FIG. **11A**, the end section **1216** may comprise a keyway **1218** into which a key **1219** is seated to prevent rotation of the arrangement of the bearing **1205a**, the bearing spacer **1210**, and the bearing **1205b** about the end section **1216**. The keyway **1218** may be formed having one or more shapes, lengths, widths, and so forth. The keyway **1218** may provide a volume into which the key **1219** is inserted to prevent the rotation. In some embodiments, the key **1219** may be one of a sunk saddle, parallel sunk, gib-head, feather, and Woodruff type key. In general, the keyway **1218** and key **1219** are configured to couple the inner rings **1223** of the one or more bearings **1205** to the shaft **1215** such that the shaft **1215** and the inner rings **1223** of the one or more bearings **1205** rotate together. In the illustrated embodiment, the end section **1216** includes an end cap **1221** that prevents the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the spacer from sliding off the end section **1216** of the shaft **1215**.

(129) In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **11B**, bearing **1205a** includes a keyway **1206a** on the inner ring **1223** of the bearing **1205a** and a keyway **1207a** on the outer ring **1225** of the bearing **1205a**. The keyway **1206a** may be configured to prevent the inner ring **1223** of the bearing **1205a** from spinning or rotating about the end section **1216** while the keyway **1207a** may prevent the outer ring **1227** of the bearing **1205a** from spinning or rotating inside the interior portion **1108** of the bearing enclosure **1105**. Though not shown in FIG. **11B**, the bearing **1205b** may also include a

keyway **1206b** on an interior ring of the bearing **1205b** and a keyway **1207b** on an exterior ring of the bearing **1205b**. The keyway **1206b** may prevent the inner ring of the bearing **1205b** from spinning or rotating about the end section **1216** while the keyway **1207b** may prevent the outer ring of the bearing **1205b** from spinning or rotating inside the interior portion **1108**. Though not shown in FIG. **11B**, the bearing spacer **1210** may include a keyway **1211** on an interior opening of the bearing spacer **1210** and a keyway **1214** on an outer circumference of the bearing spacer **1210**. The keyway **1211** may prevent the bearing spacer **1210** from spinning or rotating about the end section **1216** while the keyway **1214** may prevent the bearing spacer **1210** from spinning or rotating inside the interior portion **1108**.

(130) The larger diameter of the end section **1216** may generally match the inner diameter of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and an inner diameter of the bearing spacer **1210**, as described in further detail below. The inner diameter of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** may be substantially the same as (but slightly larger than) the diameter of the end section **1216**. Thus, the end section **1216** can be configured to hold the bearings **1205** or any bearing assembly **1110** pressed onto the end section **1216** in place using, for example, friction and compressive forces once the bearing **1205** or bearing assembly **1110** is pressed onto the end section **1216**.

(131) In some embodiments, a surface of the end section **1216** on which the bearings **1205** and the bearing assembly **1110** are attached (e.g., pressed or otherwise coupled) may comprise one or more indentations, dimples, fingers, channels, or tabs (each hereinafter referred to as indentations) at a location to which the bearing is pressed. The one or more indentations may create individual points or portions at which the surface of the end section **1216** contacts the bearings **1205** of the bearing assembly **1110** such that the end portion **1216** is not in contact with an entire interior surface of the bearings **1205**. The one or more indentations may allow air to flow around the bearings **1205** (for example, from a first side of the bearing **1205** to a second side of the bearing **1205**) when pressed onto the end section **1216** and into the bearing enclosure **1105**. Such air flow may further reduce heat build-up around the bearings **1205** when the bearings **1205** are enabling rotation or movement in the bearing enclosure **1105**. In some embodiments, the one or more indentations may be of varying depths, shapes, lengths, and heights. For example, the one or more indentations in the surface of the end section **1216** of the shaft **1215** may have a depth in the thousandths of an inch (for example, approximately 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009", 0.01", 0.02, 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween). In some embodiments, the one or more indentations may have any shape or height (for example, approximately 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009", 0.01", 0.02", 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween). The one or more indentations may also have a width sufficient to ensure that air flows from the first side to the second side of the bearing **1205** (for example a width that is slightly larger than a width or thickness of the bearing **1205**). In some embodiments, the width of the one or more indentations is slightly larger than the width of the bearing **1205**. For example, the width of the one or more indentations may be long enough such that the indentation extends on either side of the bearing **1205** by a distance of one of approximately or at least 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009", 0.01", 0.02", 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween. While described primarily as indentations, protrusions, which extend outwardly from the surface of the end section **1216** on which the bearings **1205** and the bearing assembly **1110** are attached may also be used. In cases where protrusions are utilized, the protrusions may have a height equal to the various depths of the indentations described above.

(132) The bearing spacer **1210** is described in further detail below with reference to FIG. **13**. FIG. **12A** shows a top down view of the bearing assembly **1110**. FIG. **12A** shows the the end section **1216** of the shaft **1215**, some of the middle section **1217**, a portion of the keyway **1218** in the end section **1216** that prevents rotation of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** around the end section **1216**. FIG. **12A** also shows the gap between each of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** on either side of the bearing spacer **1210**. Additionally, the

bearing **1205a** also includes the keyway **1207a** that is shown in FIG. **12A**, while the keyway **1207b** for the bearing **1205b** is not shown and the keyway **1214** for the bearing spacer **1210** is not shown. Further details regarding the bearing spacer **1210** are provided below with reference to FIG. **13**.

(133) FIG. **12B** shows a perspective view of the bearing assembly **1110**. The bearing assembly **1110** shown includes the end cap **1221** of the shaft **1215**, a portion of the middle section **1217** and the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** around the end section **1216**. FIG. **12B** also shows the gap between each of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** on either side of the bearing spacer **1210**. Additionally, FIG. **12B** shows the keyways of the bearing **1205a**, the bearing spacer **1210**, and the bearing **1205b** (for example, the keyway **1207a**, the keyway **1214**, and the keyway **1207b**) aligned such that the key can pass through and lock the rotation of the outer ring of the bearing **1205a**, the bearing spacer **1210**, and the outer ring of the bearing **1205b** within the bearing enclosure **1105**.

(134) FIG. **12C** shows an alternate perspective view of the bearing assembly **1110**. The bearing assembly **1110** shown includes the end section **1216** of the shaft **1215**, a portion of the middle section **1217**, and the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** around the end section **1216**. FIG. **12C** also shows the gap between each of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** on either side of the bearing spacer **1210**. Additionally, FIG. **12C** shows that the keyways **1207a**, **1214**, and **1207b** are aligned such that the key can pass through them and lock the rotation of the bearing **1205**, the bearing spacer **1210**, and the bearing **1205b** within the bearing enclosure **1105**.

(135) FIG. **13** shows a top-down view of the bearing spacer **1210** of the bearing assembly **1110** of FIGS. **11A-12C**. The bearing spacer **1210** shown includes a number of holes **1212** that extend from a first side of the bearing spacer **1210** to a second side of the bearing spacer **1210** and through the bearing spacer **1210**. The holes **1212** may be replaced by one or more slots, perforations, or other openings that connect the first and second sides of the bearing spacer **1210** through the bearing spacer **1210**. The holes **1212** can further facilitate airflow through the bearing support **1100** and/or around the bearings **1205** in order to further dissipate heat and provide cooling. The bearing spacer **1210** also includes the keyway **1211** introduced above that can lock rotation of the bearing spacer **1210** around the end section **1216** and the keyway **1214** that can lock rotation of the bearing spacer **1210** inside the interior portion **1108**.

(136) In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **13**, on either side of the bearing spacer **1210**, a lip **1213a** and/or **1213b** is affixed or otherwise extends (in a direction parallel to the axis of the shaft **1215**, for example) from a main body of the bearing spacer **1210**. The lips **1213a** and **1213b** may extend from the first and second sides of the bearing spacer **1210** and create the gaps between the bearing **1205a** and the bearing spacer **1210** and the bearing spacer **1210** and the bearing **1205b** discussed above. In some embodiments, the lips **1213a** and **1213b** have a height that defines the predetermined length gap. For example, the lips **1213a** and **1213b** have a height of 1 mm, 2 mm, 3 mm, 4 mm, 5 mm, 6 mm, 7 mm, 8 mm, 9 mm, or 10 mm in length and so forth, or any value therebetween. The height of the lips **1213** can be measured along a direction parallel to the axis of the shaft **1214** (when assembled). For example, the lips **1213** have a width (for example extending along the sides of the bearing spacer **1210**) of 1 mm, 2 mm, 3 mm, 4 mm, 5 mm, 6 mm, 7 mm, 8 mm, 9 mm, or 10 mm in length and so forth, or any value therebetween. The width of the lips **1213** may be short enough to not impede air flow between the inner and outer rings of the bearing **1205a** and **1205b**. The width of the lips **1213** can be measured in a radial direction (e.g., a direction perpendicular to the axis of the shaft **1215** (when assembled)).

(137) In some embodiments, the lips **1213** comprise one or more indentations, dimples, fingers, channels, or tabs (each hereinafter referred to as indentations) at a location where the bearings **1205** contact the lips **1213**. The one or more indentations may allow air to flow around the bearing **1205** within the bearing enclosure **1105**. Such air flow may further reduce heat build-up around the bearing **1205** when the bearing **1205** is enabling rotation or movement in the bearing enclosure

1105. In some embodiments, the one or more indentations may be of varying depths, shapes, lengths, and heights. For example, the one or more indentations in the lips **1213** may have a depth in the thousandths of an inch (for example, approximately 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009, 0.01", 0.02", 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween). In some embodiments, the one or more indentations may have any shape or height or width (for example, approximately 0.001", 0.002", 0.003", 0.004", 0.005", 0.006", 0.007", 0.008", 0.009, 0.01", 0.02", 0.1" and so forth, or any value therebetween). Protrusions may also be used in place of the indentations.

(138) FIGS. **14A-14C** show different views of a partial construction of the bearing assembly **1100** of FIGS. **11A-12C**, the partial construction including the first bearing **1205a**, the bearing spacer **1210**, and the shaft **1215**.

(139) FIG. **14A** shows a top down view of the partial construction of the bearing assembly **1110**. The partial construction of the bearing assembly **1110** shown also includes the end section **1216** of the shaft **1215** and some of the middle section **1217**. FIG. **14A** also shows the gap between the bearing **1205a** and the bearing spacer **1210**. Further details regarding the bearing spacer **1210** are provided below with reference to FIG. **13**.

(140) FIG. **14B** shows a slight perspective view of the partial construction of the bearing assembly **1110**. The bearing assembly **1110** shown includes the end section **1216** of the shaft **1215**, some of the middle section **1217**, a portion of the keyway **1218** in the end section **1216** that prevents rotation of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** around the end section **1216**, and a portion of the key **1219** that slides into the keyway **1218** in the end section and into the keyways **1206a** and **1206b** of the bearings **1205a** and **1205b** and keyway **1211** of the bearing spacer **1210**. FIG. **14B** also shows the gap between the bearing **1205a** and the bearing spacer **1210**. Additionally, the bearing **1205a** also includes the keyway **1207a** that is shown in FIG. **12A**, while the keyway **1211** for the bearing spacer **1210** is not shown. As shown, the key **1219** may prevent the first bearing **1205a** and the bearing spacer **1210** from spinning or rotating on the end section **1216**.

(141) FIG. **14C** shows a perspective view of the partial construction of the bearing assembly **1110**. The bearing assembly **1110** shown also includes the end section **1216** of the shaft **1215** and some of the middle section **1217**. FIG. **14C** also shows the keyway **1214** of the bearing spacer **1210** and the lip **1213** that would separate the bearing spacer **1210** from the bearing **1205b** with the gap between the bearing **1205b** and the bearing spacer **1210** as described above. Additionally, the bearing spacer **1210** includes the number of holes **1212** that enable air flow between the first and second sides of the bearing spacer **1210**.

EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

(142) The below items recite example use cases and are not meant to be limiting to the disclosure herein.

(143) Item #: 1. A apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) a driven mass configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, wherein the driven mass exists in one of (1) an extended position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle causes the driven mass to rotate and (2) a retracted position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle does not cause the driven mass to rotate; (b) a generator configured to generate an electrical output based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (c) a charger electrically coupled to the generator and configured to: (c1) receive the electrical output from the generator, (c2) generate a charge output based on the electrical output, and (c3) convey the charge output to the vehicle; (d) a hardware controller configured to control whether the driven mass is in the extended position or the retracted position in response to a signal received from a communication circuit; and (e) the communication circuit configured to receive the signal from a vehicle controller. 2. The apparatus of item 1,

wherein the driven mass comprises a wheel, and wherein the extended position comprises the wheel positioned in contact with a ground surface on which the vehicle travels. 3. The apparatus of any of items 1-2, wherein the charger comprises a charging cable coupled to a charging port of the vehicle and wherein the charge output is conveyed to the vehicle via the charging cable and the charging port. 4. The apparatus of item 3 further comprising a circuit element positioned in series with the generator and the charger, wherein the circuit element creates an open circuit between the generator and the charging port of the vehicle. 5. The apparatus of any of items 1-4 further comprising a filtering circuit configured to filter the electrical output from the generator before the electrical output from the generator is received by the charger, wherein filtering the electrical output includes one or more of filtering, cleaning, matching, converting, and conditioning the electrical output to reduce risk of damage to the charger by the electrical output. 6. The apparatus of any of items 1-5, wherein the driven mass comprises a gear, and wherein the extended position comprises the gear engaged with one or more of a drive shaft, a motor, and a wheel of the vehicle. 7. The apparatus of any of items 1-6, wherein the mechanical input is mechanically coupled to the shaft by one or more of a chain, a belt, a gearing system, and a pulley system. 8. The apparatus of any of items 1-7 further comprising an energy storage device configured to store any excess portion of the charge conveyed to the vehicle when a vehicle battery or a vehicle motor is unable to accept all portions of the charge output conveyed from the charger. 9. The apparatus of item 8, wherein the energy storage device is further configured to convey the excess portion of the charge to the vehicle energy storage device or to the vehicle motor on demand. 10. The apparatus of items 1-9, further comprising a battery storage device and a capacitor storage device, wherein the capacitor storage device is configured to: (a) receive at least a portion of the charge output, (b) store at least the portion of the charge output, and (c) convey at least the portion of the charge output to the battery storage device in one or more bursts based on a charge level of the battery storage device dropping below a threshold value. 11. A method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate, wherein the driven mass exists in (1) an extended position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle causes the driven mass to rotate and (2) a retracted position in which the kinetic energy of the vehicle does not cause the driven mass to rotate; (b) generating, via a generator, an electrical output based on a mechanical input via a generator, the generator having a mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (c) generating a charge output based on the electrical output; (d) conveying the charge output to the vehicle; (e) controlling whether the driven mass is in the extended position or the retracted position in response to a signal received from a vehicle controller; and (f) receiving the signal from the vehicle controller. 12. The method of item 11, wherein the driven mass comprises a wheel, and wherein the extended position comprises the wheel positioned in contact with a ground surface on which the vehicle travels. 13. The method of any of items 11-12, wherein conveying the charge output to the vehicle comprises conveying the charge output via a charging cable coupled to a charging port of the vehicle. 14. The method of item 13, further comprising creating an open circuit between the generator and the charging port of the vehicle via a circuit element. 15. The method of any of items 11-14 further comprising filtering the electrical output from the generator before the electrical output from the generator is received by the charger, wherein filtering the electrical output includes one or more of filtering, cleaning, matching, converting, and conditioning the electrical output to reduce risk of damage to the charger by the electrical output. 16. The method of any of items 11-15, wherein the driven mass comprises a gear, and wherein the extended position comprises the gear engaged with one or more of a drive shaft, a motor, and a wheel of the vehicle. 17. The method of any of items 11-16, wherein the mechanical input is mechanically coupled to the shaft by one or more of a chain, a belt, a gearing system, and a pulley system. 18. The method of any of items 11-17 further comprising storing any excess portion of the charge conveyed to the vehicle when a vehicle battery

or a vehicle motor is unable to accept all portions of the charge output conveyed from the charger.

19. The method of item 18 further comprising conveying the excess portion of the charge from the energy storage device to the vehicle energy storage device or to the vehicle on demand.

20. The method of any of items 11-19 further comprising: (a) receiving at least a portion of the charge output at a capacitor storage device; (b) storing at least the portion of the charge output in the capacitor storage device; and (c) conveying at least the portion of the charge output to a battery storage device in one or more bursts based on a charge level of the battery storage device dropping below a threshold value.

21. The apparatus of any of items 1-10, wherein the mechanical input further comprises a flywheel configured to drive the generator to generate the electrical output.

22. The apparatus of item 21, further comprising a one-way bearing having a first side and a second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the first side rotate independently of the second side.

23. The apparatus of item 22, wherein the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, the shaft is coupled to the second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft.

24. The apparatus of any of items 1-10 and 21-23 further comprising an independent suspension that supports the driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber.

25. The apparatus of any of items 1-10 and 21-24, wherein the generator is switchable such that the electrical output is pulsed in a first switched setting and is constant in a second switched setting.

26. The apparatus of any of items 1-10 and 21-25 further comprising a capacitor and switch assembly configured to provide a backup energy storage for high voltage transfer the electrical output generated by the generator.

27. The method of any of items 11-20, wherein the mechanical input comprises a flywheel configured to drive the generator to generate the electrical output.

28. The method of item 27, wherein the mechanical input further comprises a one-way bearing having a first side and a second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the first side rotate independently of the second side in a first direction of rotation and with the second side in a second direction of rotation.

29. The method of item 28, wherein the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, the shaft is coupled to the second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft in the first direction of rotation and with the shaft in the second direction of rotation.

30. The method of any of items 11-20 and 27-29, further comprising supporting, via an independent suspension, the driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber.

31. The method of any of items 11-20 and 27-30, further comprising switching the generator such that the electrical output is pulsed in a first switched setting and is constant in a second switched setting.

32. The method of any of items 11-20 and 27-31, further comprising performing a voltage dump from the generator output terminal via a capacitor, a switch assembly, and a backup energy storage.

33. An apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) a driven mass configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate; (b) a generator configured to generate an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (c) a capacitor module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal and configured to: (c1) receive a first portion of the electrical output generated by the generator, (c2) store the first portion of the electrical output as a first energy as an electric field of the capacitor module, and (c3) convey the first energy to a load of the vehicle on demand; (d) a battery module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal and configured to: (d1) receive a second portion of the electrical output generated by the generator, (d2) store the second portion of the electrical output as a second energy in a chemical energy form, and (d3) convey the second energy to the load of the vehicle on demand; and (e) a hardware controller configured to control whether the capacitor

module, the battery module, or a combination of the capacitor module and the battery module is coupled to the generator output terminal in response to a received signal. 34. The apparatus of item 33, wherein the mechanical input comprises a flywheel configured to store mechanical energy received from the driven mass. 35. The apparatus of item 34, further comprising a one-way bearing having a first side and a second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the first side rotate independently of the second side in a first direction of rotation and together with the second side in a second direction of rotation. 36. The apparatus of item 35, wherein the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, wherein the shaft is coupled to the second side, and wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft in the first direction of rotation and together with the shaft in the second direction of rotation. 37. The apparatus of any of items 1-10, 21-26, and 33-36, further comprising an independent suspension that supports the driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber. 38. A method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate; (b) generating, via generator, an electrical output at a generator output terminal of the generator based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (c) conveying a first portion of the electrical output generated by the generator to a capacitor module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal; (d) storing the first portion of the electrical output as a first energy in an electric field of the capacitor module; (e) conveying the first energy to a load of the vehicle on demand; (f) conveying a second portion of the electrical output to a battery module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal; (g) storing the second portion of the electrical output as a second energy in a chemical energy form; and (h) controlling whether the capacitor module, the battery module, or a combination of the capacitor module and the battery module is coupled to the generator output terminal in response to a received signal. 39. The method of item 38, wherein the mechanical input comprises a flywheel configured to store mechanical energy received from the driven mass. 40. The method of item 39, wherein the mechanical input further comprises a one-way bearing having a first side and a second side, wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the first side rotate independently of the second side in a first direction of rotation and together with the second side in a second direction of rotation. 41. The method of item 40, wherein the flywheel is mechanically coupled to the first side of the one-way bearing, wherein the shaft is coupled to the second side, and wherein the one-way bearing is configured to allow the flywheel rotate independently of the shaft in the first direction of rotation and together with the shaft in the second direction of rotation. 42. The method of any of items 11-20, 27-32, and 38-41, further comprising supporting, via an independent suspension, the driven mass and the generator independently from a suspension of the vehicle, wherein the independent suspension comprises one of a linkage, a spring, and a shock absorber. 43. The apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) a driven mass configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate; (b) a generator configured to generate an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (c) a hardware controller configured to: (c1) convey at least a first portion of the electrical output to one of a capacitor module, a battery, and a motor of the vehicle, each of the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor selectively coupled to the generator output terminal, (c2) disconnect the generator output terminal from the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor in response to an interrupt signal received, (c3) initiate a dump of a residual electrical energy in the generator for a period of time, and (c4) connect the generator output terminal to one of the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor of the vehicle after the

period of time expires, wherein the interrupt signal is generated by a controller in response to one or more conditions. 44. The apparatus of item 43, wherein the interrupt signal is received at periodic intervals defined based on at least one of a period of time following a previous interrupt signal, a distance traveled by the vehicle, a speed of the vehicle, and a power generated by the generator. 45. The apparatus of item 44, wherein the hardware controller configured to dump the residual electrical energy comprises the hardware controller being configured to: (a) electrically couple the generator output terminal to a dump load for the period of time, and (b) disconnect the generator output terminal from the dump load after the period of time passes, wherein the dump load comprises one or more of a back-up battery or capacitor. 46. A method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate; (b) generating an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (c) conveying at least a first portion of the electrical output to one of a capacitor module, a battery, and a motor of the vehicle selectively coupled to the generator output terminal; (d) disconnecting the generator output terminal from the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor in response to an interrupt signal received; (e) dumping a residual electrical energy in the generator for a period of time; and (f) connecting the generator output terminal to one of the capacitor module, the battery, and the motor of the vehicle after the period of time expires, wherein the interrupt signal is generated by a controller in response to one or more conditions. 47. The method of item 46, wherein the interrupt signal is received at periodic intervals defined based on at least one of a period of time following a previous interrupt signal, a distance traveled by the vehicle, a speed of the vehicle, and a power generated by the generator. 48. The method of item 47, wherein dumping the residual electrical energy comprises: (a) electrically coupling the generator output terminal to a dump load for the period of time; and (b) disconnecting the generator output terminal from the dump load after the period of time passes, wherein the dump load comprises one or more of a back-up battery or capacitor. 49. An apparatus for providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) a motor configured to place the vehicle in motion; (b) a driven mass configured to rotate in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle generated when the vehicle is in motion, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate; (c) a generator configured to generate an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on rotation of a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (d) a capacitor module selectively and electrically coupled to the generator output terminal and configured to: (d1) receive a portion of the electrical output generated by the generator, (d2) store the portion of the electrical output as an electric field of the capacitor module when the battery has a charge that exceeds a threshold value, and (d3) convey the first energy to a load of the vehicle on demand, (e) a hardware controller configured to control the motor, the generator, and coupling of the capacitor module to the generator module, wherein the electrical output generated is greater than or equal to a consumption of the motor of the vehicle when the vehicle is in motion. 50. A method of providing electrical charge to a vehicle, comprising: (a) rotating a driven mass in response to a kinetic energy of the vehicle, the driven mass coupled to a shaft such that rotation of the driven mass causes the shaft to rotate; (b) generating, by a generator, an electrical output at a generator output terminal based on rotation of a mechanical input, the mechanical input mechanically coupled to the shaft such that rotation of the shaft causes the mechanical input to rotate; (c) conveying a portion of the electrical output to a capacitor module selectively coupled to the generator output terminal with a battery of the vehicle; and (d) storing the portion of the electrical output in the capacitor module when the battery has a charge that exceeds a threshold value, wherein the electrical output generated by the generator is greater than or equal to a consumption of a motor of the vehicle when the vehicle is in motion.

Additional Embodiments

(144) As described herein, the generators **302a** and **302b** may be configured to generate a voltage of any amount, type, and so forth, for example, as specified by an operating voltage of the battery **102** and/or a bus voltage of the BEV **100/500**. As such, any of the deep cycle battery **504** and the capacitor modules **502** may also have operating voltages corresponding to that of the battery **102**. In some embodiments, the deep cycle battery **504** and/or the capacitor modules **502** have different operating voltages and are coupled to the battery **102** via one or more converter devices, for example the DC-to-DC converter **506**. As such, the OBCS **210** and corresponding components described herein may operate at various voltages for the BEV **100/500**.

(145) As used herein, “system,” “instrument,” “apparatus,” and “device” generally encompass both the hardware (for example, mechanical and electronic) and, in some implementations, associated software (for example, specialized computer programs for graphics control) components.

(146) Further, the data processing and interactive and dynamic user interfaces described herein are enabled by innovations in efficient data processing and interactions between the user interfaces and underlying systems and components.

(147) It is to be understood that not necessarily all objects or advantages may be achieved in accordance with any particular embodiment described herein. Thus, for example, those skilled in the art will recognize that certain embodiments may be configured to operate in a manner that achieves or optimizes one advantage or group of advantages as taught herein without necessarily achieving other objects or advantages as may be taught or suggested herein.

(148) Each of the processes, methods, and algorithms described in the preceding sections may be embodied in, and fully or partially automated by, code modules executed by one or more computer systems or computer processors including computer hardware. The code modules may be stored on any type of non-transitory computer-readable medium or computer storage device, such as hard drives, solid state memory, optical disc, and/or the like. The systems and modules may also be transmitted as generated data signals (for example, as part of a carrier wave or other analog or digital propagated signal) on a variety of computer-readable transmission mediums, including wireless-based and wired/cable-based mediums, and may take a variety of forms (for example, as part of a single or multiplexed analog signal, or as multiple discrete digital packets or frames). The processes and algorithms may be implemented partially or wholly in application-specific circuitry. The results of the disclosed processes and process steps may be stored, persistently or otherwise, in any type of non-transitory computer storage such as, for example, volatile or non-volatile storage.

(149) Many other variations than those described herein will be apparent from this disclosure. For example, depending on the embodiment, certain acts, events, or functions of any of the algorithms described herein can be performed in a different sequence, can be added, merged, or left out altogether (for example, not all described acts or events are necessary for the practice of the algorithms). Moreover, in certain embodiments, acts or events can be performed concurrently, for example, through multi-threaded processing, interrupt processing, or multiple processors or processor cores or on other parallel architectures, rather than sequentially. In addition, different tasks or processes can be performed by different machines and/or computing systems that can function together.

(150) The various illustrative logical blocks, modules, and algorithm elements described in connection with the embodiments disclosed herein can be implemented as electronic hardware, computer software, or combinations of both. To clearly illustrate this interchangeability of hardware and software, various illustrative components, blocks, modules, and elements have been described herein generally in terms of their functionality. Whether such functionality is implemented as hardware or software depends upon the particular application and design constraints imposed on the overall system. The described functionality can be implemented in varying ways for each particular application, but such implementation decisions should not be interpreted as causing a departure from the scope of the disclosure.

(151) The various features and processes described herein may be used independently of one another, or may be combined in various ways. All possible combinations and sub-combinations are intended to fall within the scope of this disclosure. In addition, certain method or process blocks may be omitted in some implementations. The methods and processes described herein are also not limited to any particular sequence, and the blocks or states relating thereto can be performed in other sequences that are appropriate. For example, described blocks or states may be performed in an order other than that specifically disclosed, or multiple blocks or states may be combined in a single block or state. The example blocks or states may be performed in serial, in parallel, or in some other manner. Blocks or states may be added to or removed from the disclosed example embodiments. The example systems and components described herein may be configured differently than described. For example, elements may be added to, removed from, or rearranged compared to the disclosed example embodiments.

(152) The various illustrative logical blocks and modules described in connection with the embodiments disclosed herein can be implemented or performed by a machine, such as a general purpose processor, a digital signal processor (“DSP”), an application specific integrated circuit (“ASIC”), a field programmable gate array (“FPGA”) or other programmable logic device, discrete gate or transistor logic, discrete hardware components, or any combination thereof designed to perform the functions described herein. A general purpose processor can be a microprocessor, but in the alternative, the processor can be a controller, microcontroller, or state machine, combinations of the same, or the like. A processor can include electrical circuitry configured to process computer-executable instructions. In another embodiment, a processor includes an FPGA or other programmable devices that performs logic operations without processing computer-executable instructions. A processor can also be implemented as a combination of computing devices, for example, a combination of a DSP and a microprocessor, a plurality of microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in conjunction with a DSP core, or any other such configuration. Although described herein primarily with respect to digital technology, a processor may also include primarily analog components. For example, some, or all, of the signal processing algorithms described herein may be implemented in analog circuitry or mixed analog and digital circuitry. A computing environment can include any type of computer system, including, but not limited to, a computer system based on a microprocessor, a mainframe computer, a digital signal processor, a portable computing device, a device controller, or a computational engine within an appliance, to name a few.

(153) The elements of a method, process, or algorithm described in connection with the embodiments disclosed herein can be embodied directly in hardware, in a software module stored in one or more memory devices and executed by one or more processors, or in a combination of the two. A software module can reside in RAM memory, flash memory, ROM memory, EPROM memory, EEPROM memory, registers, hard disk, a removable disk, a CD-ROM, or any other form of non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, media, or physical computer storage known in the art. An example storage medium can be coupled to the processor such that the processor can read information from, and write information to, the storage medium. In the alternative, the storage medium can be integral to the processor. The storage medium can be volatile or nonvolatile. The processor and the storage medium can reside in an ASIC. The ASIC can reside in a user terminal. In the alternative, the processor and the storage medium can reside as discrete components in a user terminal.

(154) Conditional language, such as, among others, “can,” “could,” “might,” or “may,” unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements and/or steps. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements and/or steps are in any way required for one or more embodiments or that one or more embodiments necessarily include logic for deciding, with or without user input or

prompting, whether these features, elements and/or steps are included or are to be performed in any particular embodiment.

(155) As used herein a “data storage system” may be embodied in computing system that utilizes hard disk drives, solid state memories and/or any other type of non-transitory computer-readable storage medium accessible to or by a device such as an access device, server, or other computing device described. A data storage system may also or alternatively be distributed or partitioned across multiple local and/or remote storage devices as is known in the art without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. In yet other embodiments, a data storage system may include or be embodied in a data storage web service.

(156) As used herein, the terms “determine” or “determining” encompass a wide variety of actions. For example, “determining” may include calculating, computing, processing, deriving, looking up (for example, looking up in a table, a database or another data structure), ascertaining and the like. Also, “determining” may include receiving (for example, receiving information), accessing (for example, accessing data in a memory) and the like. Also, “determining” may include resolving, selecting, choosing, establishing, and the like.

(157) As used herein, the term “selectively” or “selective” may encompass a wide variety of actions. For example, a “selective” process may include determining one option from multiple options. A “selective” process may include one or more of: dynamically determined inputs, preconfigured inputs, or user-initiated inputs for making the determination. In some implementations, an n-input switch may be included to provide selective functionality where n is the number of inputs used to make the selection.

(158) As used herein, the terms “provide” or “providing” encompass a wide variety of actions. For example, “providing” may include storing a value in a location for subsequent retrieval, transmitting a value directly to the recipient, transmitting or storing a reference to a value, and the like. “Providing” may also include encoding, decoding, encrypting, decrypting, validating, verifying, and the like.

(159) As used herein, the term “message” encompasses a wide variety of formats for communicating (for example, transmitting or receiving) information. A message may include a machine readable aggregation of information such as an XML document, fixed field message, comma separated message, or the like. A message may, in some implementations, include a signal utilized to transmit one or more representations of the information. While recited in the singular, it will be understood that a message may be composed, transmitted, stored, received, etc. in multiple parts.

(160) As used herein a “user interface” (also referred to as an interactive user interface, a graphical user interface or a UI) may refer to a network based interface including data fields and/or other controls for receiving input signals or providing electronic information and/or for providing information to the user in response to any received input signals. A UI may be implemented in whole or in part using technologies such as hyper-text mark-up language (HTML), ADOBE® FLASH®, JAVA®, MICROSOFT® .NET®, web services, and rich site summary (RSS). In some implementations, a UI may be included in a stand-alone client (for example, thick client, fat client) configured to communicate (for example, send or receive data) in accordance with one or more of the aspects described.

(161) Disjunctive language such as the phrase “at least one of X, Y, or Z,” unless specifically stated otherwise, is otherwise understood with the context as used in general to present that an item, term, and so forth, may be either X, Y, or Z, or any combination thereof (for example, X, Y, and/or Z). Thus, such disjunctive language is not generally intended to, and should not, imply that certain embodiments require at least one of X, at least one of Y, or at least one of Z to each be present.

(162) Any process descriptions, elements, or blocks in the flow diagrams described herein and/or depicted in the attached figures should be understood as potentially representing modules, segments, or portions of code which include one or more executable instructions for implementing

specific logical functions or steps in the process. Alternate implementations are included within the scope of the embodiments described herein in which elements or functions may be deleted, executed out of order from that shown or discussed, including substantially concurrently or in reverse order, depending on the functionality involved, as would be understood by those skilled in the art.

(163) Unless otherwise explicitly stated, articles such as “a” or “an” should generally be interpreted to include one or more described items. Accordingly, phrases such as “a device configured to” are intended to include one or more recited devices. Such one or more recited devices can also be collectively configured to carry out the stated recitations. For example, “a processor configured to carry out recitations A, B and C” can include a first processor configured to carry out recitation A working in conjunction with a second processor configured to carry out recitations B and C.

(164) All of the methods and processes described herein may be embodied in, and partially or fully automated via, software code modules executed by one or more general purpose computers. For example, the methods described herein may be performed by the computing system and/or any other suitable computing device. The methods may be executed on the computing devices in response to execution of software instructions or other executable code read from a tangible computer readable medium. A tangible computer readable medium is a data storage device that can store data that is readable by a computer system. Examples of computer readable mediums include read-only memory, random-access memory, other volatile or non-volatile memory devices, CD-ROMs, magnetic tape, flash drives, and optical data storage devices.

(165) It should be emphasized that many variations and modifications may be made to the herein-described embodiments, the elements of which are to be understood as being among other acceptable examples. All such modifications and variations are intended to be included herein within the scope of this disclosure. The foregoing description details certain embodiments. It will be appreciated, however, that no matter how detailed the foregoing appears in text, the systems and methods can be practiced in many ways. As is also stated herein, it should be noted that the use of particular terminology when describing certain features or aspects of the systems and methods should not be taken to imply that the terminology is being re-defined herein to be restricted to including any specific characteristics of the features or aspects of the systems and methods with which that terminology is associated.

(166) Those of skill in the art would understand that information, messages, and signals may be represented using any of a variety of different technologies and techniques. For example, data, instructions, commands, information, signals, bits, symbols, and chips that may be referenced throughout the above description may be represented by voltages, currents, electromagnetic waves, magnetic fields or particles, optical fields or particles, or any combination thereof

Claims

1. A system for managing energy within a vehicle, the system comprising: an on-board energy generation system configured to generate an energy output; a first energy storage device selectively electrically coupled with the on-board energy generation system; a second energy storage device selectively electrically coupled with the on-board energy generation system, the second energy storage device having a different power density than the first energy storage device and a different energy density than the first energy storage device; a motor configured to convert electrical energy to mechanical energy to cause one or more wheels of the vehicle to rotate; a switch assembly electrically coupled with the on-board energy generation system and configured to control selective electrical coupling between the second energy storage device and the on-board energy generation system responsive to input from an operator of the vehicle to control dumping energy from the on-board energy generation system to the second energy storage device; and a hardware controller configured to: control selective electrical coupling between the first energy storage device and the

on-board energy generation system via the switch assembly automatically based on one or more of time or distance travelled by the vehicle to automatically control dumping energy from the on-board energy generation system to the first energy storage device; monitor a charge level of the second energy storage device and an energy demand of the motor; control electrically coupling the first energy storage device with the second energy storage device based on at least the charge level of the second energy storage device or the energy demand of the motor; and control electrically coupling the motor to the first energy storage device or to the second energy storage device.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the hardware controller is further configured to control selective electrical coupling between the motor and the on-board energy generation system via the switch assembly based on at least the time or the distance travelled by the vehicle.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the hardware controller is configured to control selective electrical coupling between the first energy storage device and the on-board energy generation system based on one or more of a speed of the vehicle, and the energy output.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the switch assembly is configured to control selective electrical coupling between the first energy storage device and the on-board energy generation system based on at least a user input.
5. The system of claim 1, wherein the hardware controller is further configured to electrically couple the first energy storage device with the second energy storage device when the charge level of the second energy storage device surpasses a threshold.
6. The system of claim 1, wherein the hardware controller is further configured to generate an alert relating to energy levels or charging requirements of the vehicle.
7. The system of claim 6, wherein the hardware controller is further configured to cause the alert to display to a user of the vehicle.
8. The system of claim 6, wherein the hardware controller is further configured to communicate the alert to a remote system that is remote the vehicle.
9. The system of claim 1, wherein the first energy storage device comprises a voltage capacity of at least 380 volts, wherein the second energy storage device comprises a voltage capacity of at least 380 volts.
10. The system of claim 1, wherein the on-board energy generation system comprises a solar panel.
11. The system of claim 1, wherein the on-board energy generation system is configured to generate the energy output from kinetic energy of the vehicle, wherein the on-board energy generation system comprises one or more of a regenerative braking system or a driven component.
12. The system of claim 1, wherein the on-board energy generation system comprises a driven component configured to rotate in response to one or more of a drive shaft of the vehicle or a wheel of the vehicle.
13. The system of claim 12, further comprising a flywheel selectively coupled to the driven component and configured to rotate based on at least a rotation of the driven component and an inertia of the flywheel to store a kinetic energy generated by the rotation of the driven component.
14. A method for managing energy within a vehicle, the method comprising: selectively electrically coupling an on-board energy generation system with a first energy storage device based one or more of time or distance travelled by the vehicle to automatically control dumping energy from the on-board energy generation system to the first energy storage device; selectively electrically coupling the on-board energy generation system with a second energy storage device responsive to input from an operator of the vehicle to control dumping energy from the on-board energy generation system to the second energy storage device, the second energy storage device having a different power density than the first energy storage device and a different energy density than the first energy storage device; monitoring a charge level of the second energy storage device and an energy demand of a motor of the vehicle; and controlling an electrical coupling between the first energy storage device and the second energy storage device based on at least the charge level of the second energy storage device or the energy demand of the motor.

15. The method of claim 14, further comprising electrically coupling the motor with the first energy storage device or the second energy storage device.
 16. The method of claim 14, further comprising selectively electrically coupling the on-board energy generation system with the motor based on at least the one or more conditions.
 17. The method of claim 14, wherein the one or more conditions further includes one or more of a speed of the vehicle, and an energy generated by the on-board energy generation system.
 18. The method of claim 14, wherein the one or more conditions comprises the user input.
 19. The method of claim 14, further comprising: generating an alert relating to energy levels or charging requirements of the vehicle; and causing the alert to display to a user of the vehicle or communicating the alert to a remote system.
 20. A computer system comprising: one or more hardware computer processors configured to execute program instructions to cause the computer system to: selectively electrically couple an on-board energy generation system of a vehicle with a first energy storage device based on one or more of time or distance travelled by the vehicle to automatically control dumping energy from the on-board energy generation system to the first energy storage device; selectively electrically couple the on-board energy generation system with a second energy storage device responsive to input from an operator of the vehicle to control dumping energy from the on-board energy generation system to the second energy storage device, the second energy storage device having a different power density than the first energy storage device and a different energy density than the first energy storage device; monitor a charge level of the second energy storage device and an energy demand of a motor of a vehicle; and control an electrical coupling between the first energy storage device and the second energy storage device based on at least the charge level of the second energy storage device or the energy demand of the motor.
 21. The computer system of claim 20, wherein the one or more hardware computer processors are further configured to execute the program instructions to cause the computer system to selectively electrically couple the on-board energy generation system with the motor based on at least the one or more conditions.
 22. The computer system of claim 20, wherein the one or more conditions further includes one or more of a speed of the vehicle, and an energy generated by the on-board energy generation system.
 23. The computer system of claim 20, wherein the one or more hardware computer processors are further configured to execute the program instructions to cause the computer system to selectively electrically couple the on-board energy generation system with the first energy storage device based on at least the user input.
 24. The computer system of claim 20, wherein the one or more hardware computer processors are further configured to execute the program instructions to cause the computer system to: generate an alert relating to energy levels or charging requirements of the vehicle; and cause the alert to display to a user of the vehicle or communicate the alert to a remote system.
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